The Plough

NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

Issue February 2026

Featuring

A History of Charlemagne
Robert Williams
Charlemagne lingers over history as the greatest unifier of Europe since the pre-Christian ancients. Robert Williams gives a popular sketch of the history of this Christian hero.
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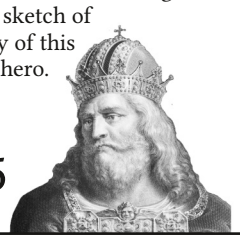

Culture as Propaganda
Frank Wright
The culture of our modern world is manufactured propaganda: fighting a peace-time war for the liberal regime. Frank Wright expertly traces the lineage of this revolutionary strategy.
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The Value of Work
Fr Cuthbert OSFC
Is work optional? In the garden, Adam was given work. But by the fall of man, work was to become burdensome, but also salvific. Fr Cuthbert gives the analysis, using a comparison between the layman and the monks.
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Cardinal Gomá's Support of Franco

Pastoral Letter of this Spanish Prelate

Isidro Gomá y Tomás

The Plough presents an English translation of this pastoral letter. Cardinal Gomá y Tomás was the highest ranking Spanish prelate, being the Archbishop of Toledo, and was made a Cardinal by Pope Pius IX in 1935.

At the time of its publication in 1936, Spain was embroilled in a bloody civil war. On one side, sat the so-called Republican faction, who held de-facto the reigns of state power in Spain. Under the republican regime, Jewish bolshevism was allowed to flourish and its grip on Spain was growing daily.

On the opposing side, was the Nationalist faction. This faction was lead by a band of military generals, who, motivated by their love of Spain and her ancient Catholic traditions, were compelled by their duty to mobilise against the Republican regime. By decisive action and gallantry, these generals—Francisco Franco among them—won the day for Spain and the Catholic Church. After the conclusion of the civil war in 1939, Franco took the reigns as the leader of the Spanish State. Until his death in 1975, Spain enjoyed a political and economic stability coupled with a moral revival: The Church had full rights in Spain, blasphemy and indecent publications were censored and family life flourished.

When the military uprising against the Government of the Spanish Nation broke out last July, no one could have imagined that it would take on the gravity it has today, both nationally and internationally. So vast and profound is the current that has determined this war which initially bore the common traits of any civil war—that it has not only shaken everything in Spain but has also impassioned and moved the entire world.

As happens in these cases, especially in this one, where most deplorable acts that are inconsistent with our tradition, our history, and even our racial temperament have occurred, world opinion has been divided in judging the culminating events of this very harsh war.

It pleases us to give due honor to the Bishops and faithful of many nations who, through us, have wished to express to the Spanish people their admiration for the almost legendary virility with which a large part of the nation has risen up to free itself from a spiritual oppression that contradicted its feelings and its history, while some of them generously aided our needs created by the terrible scourge. It is the expression of the bond of Christian charity that, as it binds individuals and families together and brings them closer in days of tribulation, so it does in this order of Catholic internationalism, in which we all form the great mystical body whose Head is Jesus Christ, our Father and Lord.

We have corresponded, on behalf of the Churches of Spain, to these generous and spontaneous displays of fraternity, which have brought encouragement and consolation to all in tribulation, conveying to our brothers outside of Spain our gratitude and urging them to pray for the salvation of the highest interests that are being contested today in our beloved homeland.

But along with the testimony of the cordial support of the Brothers from outside Spain and of the Catholics whom they govern and represent, doubts and inquiries have reached us about the nature of the events that are occurring among us. Part of the foreign press treats the incidents of the war with notorious frivolity, invents slanderous facts, or falsifies the true ones. They do so with the danger of misleading international opinion and perhaps also with the intention to cause damage to our country by means of an inaccurate or false concept of the conflict that today divides Spaniards.

Therefore, believing that We are interpreting the sentiment of the Episcopate and the true Spanish people, We have deemed opportune this simple Document in which we synthetically reflect the historical profile of this war and its national meaning, with the conclusions that derive from the facts. By giving it due publicity, through the same means by which we were questioned and by which the significance of our war has been distorted and twisted, we may perhaps render a service to the Church and to the Homeland, which today demand the effort and collaboration of all.

Civil War?

The war that continues to ravage much of Spain and destroy magnificent cities is not, in what it has of being both popular and national, a conflict of a political nature in the strict sense of the word. It is not fought for the Republic, although the partisans of a certain kind of Republic want it to be. Nor has the solution of a dynastic question been the motive for the war, because today even the question of the form of government has been relegated to the background. Nor are inter-regional problems being fought out with arms within the heart of the great homeland, although in the period of struggle, and gravely complicating it, flags have been raised that embody longings for more or less provincial claims.

This most bloody war is, at its root, a war of principles, of doctrines, of one concept of life and of the social fact against another, of one civilization against another. It is the war that the Christian and Spanish spirit sustains against this other spirit, if spirit it can be called, that would like to fuse everything human, from the heights of thought to the pettiness of daily living, into the mold of Marxist materialism. On one side, combatants of every ideology that represents, partially or integrally, the old tradition and history of Spain; on the other, an amorphous conglomerate of combatants whose main effort is, more than to defeat the enemy, or, if you will, through triumph over the enemy, to destroy all the values of our old civilization.

We do not know how and for what purposes the military insurrection of July occurred: we assume them to be of the highest order. The subsequent course of events has demonstrated that it was determined, and has been subsequently informed, by a profound sense of love for the homeland. Spain was already almost at the bottom of the abyss, and it was desired to save her by the force of the sword. Perhaps there was no other remedy.

What we can affirm, because we are witnesses of it, is that, when a part of the army pronounced itself against the old state of affairs, the national soul felt deeply

"This most bloody war is, at its root, a war of principles, of doctrines, of one concept of life and of the social fact against another, of one civilization against another."

struck and was incorporated, in a deep and vast current, into the military movement; first, with the sympathy and longing with which a hope of salvation is seen to arise, and then, with the contribution of enthusiastic national militias, of every political tendency, who offered, without limit or agreements, their assistance to the army, generously giving lives and fortunes, so that the initial movement would not fail. And it did not fail—we have heard it from prestigious military men—precisely because of the armed participation of the national militias.

It is necessary to have lived through those days of the first fortnight of August in Navarre which, with a population of 320,000 inhabitants, put on a war footing more than 40,000 volunteers, almost all of the men fit for arms, who, leaving the

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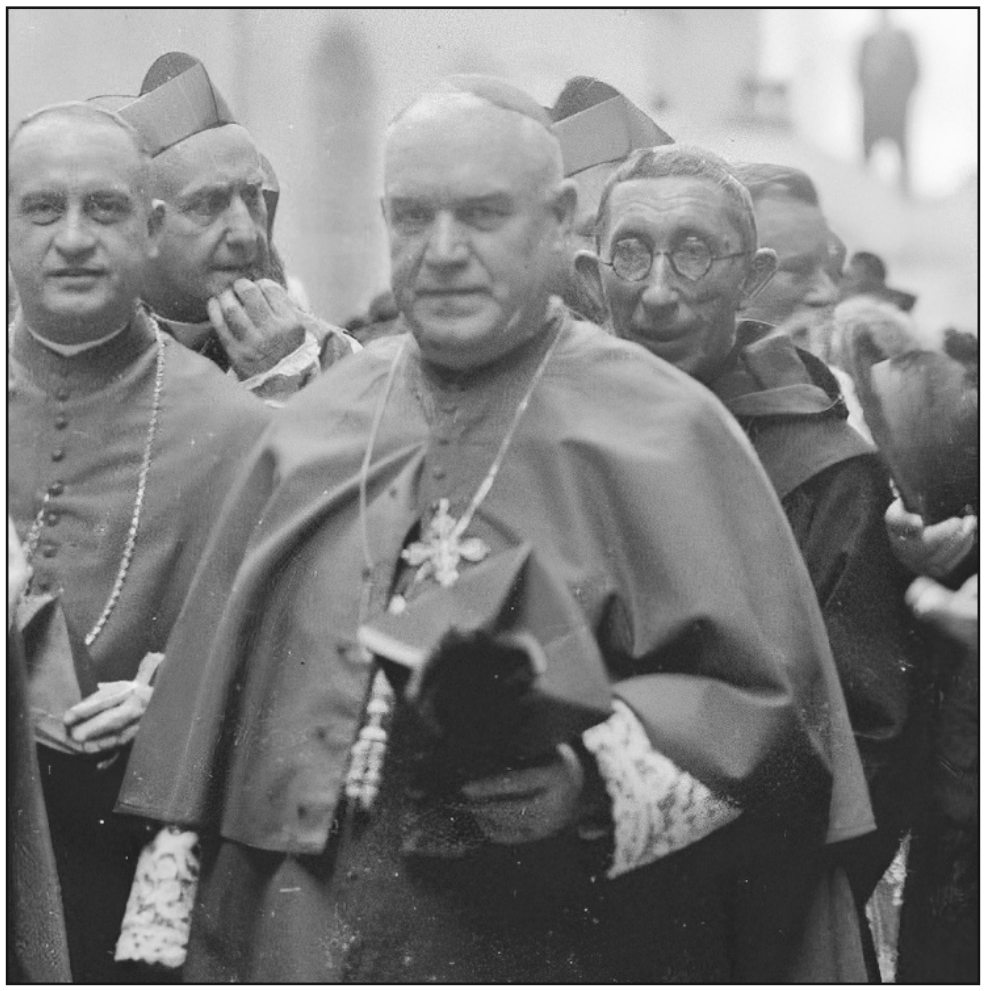

Cardinal Isidro Gomá y Tomás (1869–1940): it is said that there wasn't a Nationalist's rifle that wasn't blessed by him.

Cardinal Gomá's Support of Franco Cont.

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sheaves on their threshing floors and letting women and children raise the harvests, left for the battle fronts with no other ideal than the defense of their religion and of the homeland. First, they went to war for God; and it would be a great service to Spain if someone were to compile, as in a heroic anthology, the numerous episodes of enlistment in Navarre, which, as it was in other times the mother of kingdoms, has today been the heart from which the emotion and strength of the momentous moments in history have radiated to all our land.

In step with Navarre, the Spanish spirit has risen powerfully in the other regions not subjected at first blow to the governmental armies. Aragon, Old Castile, León, and Andalusia have contributed large contingents of militias that, under the various denominations of the old political organizations, have joined together, in one compact whole, with the national army. And on all fronts, the Divine Host has been seen raised in the holy sacrifice, and consciences have been purified by the confessions of thousands of young soldiers, and while the weapons were silent, the collective prayer of the Holy Rosary resounded in the camps. In cities and villages, a profound religious reaction has been observed, of which we have not seen an equal example.

It is because Religion and the Fatherland —*arae et foci*—were in grave danger, brought to the edge of the abyss by a policy totally at odds with national sentiment and with our history. This is why the reaction was more vivid where the spirit of religion and homeland was best preserved. And this is why this movement achieved the religious nuance that has manifested itself in the camps of our militias, in the sacred insignia worn by the combatants, and in the explosion of religious enthusiasm of the rearguard multitudes.

Take away, the force of religious sentiment, and the current war is enervated. Certainly, the spirit of the homeland has been the great spring that has mobilized the masses of combatants; but no one ignores that the spring of religion, acting in the regions where it is most deeply rooted, has given the largest initial contingent and the greatest bravery to our soldiers. Moreover, we are convinced that the war would have been lost for the insurgents without the divine stimulus that has made the soul of the Christian people vibrate, who enlisted in the war or who sustained with their encouragement, outside the fronts, those who were fighting.

Let it remain, then, on this part as an irrefutable thing that if the current conflict appears as a purely civil war, because it is on Spanish soil and by the Spanish themselves where the struggle is sustained, in the background one must recognize in it a spirit of true crusade in favor of the Catholic religion, whose sap has vivified the history of Spain for centuries and has constituted as the core of its organization and its life.

This phenomenon—which others will call an explosion of religious fanaticism, but which is nothing more than the conscientious and heroic gesture of a people wounded in their most vivid loves by bastard laws and practices and who add their effort to that of the weapons that can redeem them—offers us the firm hope that days of peace will come for consciences. We hope that in the organization of the future Spanish State, God and his Church will have at least the rights of citizenship that they have in all civilized peoples. We hope for the Church's freedom and protection that until a few years ago, had been the primary ingredient of the spiritual life of our people, the support of our history and the only key to interpret it. Effects follow causes. How could the seed sown in the fields of Spain not germinate in Catholic soil, in the furrow opened at the point of the sword by the effort of Catholics and watered with their blood?

Let us undo, however, a warning that could be most ominous for future times. War against Marxist communism as the current one is, is not against the proletariat, largely corrupted by Marxist preachings. It would be a slander and a crime, the germ of a future class war in which religion would necessarily be involved, to attribute to it a consortium, with the sword to humiliate the working class, or even to protect old abuses that should not have lasted until now.

Let the workers not fear, whoever they may be. And let them not fear be they affiliated to any of the groups or unions that pursue the aim of improving the class. Neither the sword nor religion are their adversaries: the sword, because it is occupied in the heroic effort of pacifying Spain, without which tranquil and remunerative work is impossible; religion, because it was always the protection of the defenseless and the definitive factor of charity and social justice. If it is God's will that the national army triumphs, the workers can be sure that, leaving behind the ballast of a doctrine and procedures that are by their very essence destructive to the social order, they will have definitively entered the path of achieving their just demands.

As far as the Church is concerned, and as representatives that we are of it, we assure our concurrence, in the doctrinal order and in social life, to any enterprise that has as its aim the dignity of the working class and the establishment of a reign of equity and justice that ties all Spaniards with the bonds of a fraternity that will not be found outside of it.

And let it not be said anymore that a war that has had its main spring in the Christian spirit of Spain has had as its object to ossify our economic and social life. It is a war of systems or civilizations; it can never be called a class war. This is demonstrated by the sense of religion and homeland that have raised Spain against Anti-Spain.

Against God and Spain

The action of the opposite party offers, by contraposition, the same result. No one ignores today that for the same days in which the national movement broke out, communism had prepared instead a subversive movement. Anything that signified a support, a foundation, a social bond of our old Christian civilization had to succumb. Religion, property, family, authority, the basic institutions of the old order of things had to suffer the tremendous battering of the revolution, organized to destroy everything and to erect the Soviet regime on its ruins. Five years of propaganda, of inconceivable tolerance, of organization, of stockpiling war material: these foreshadowed the outbreak, almost on a fixed term.

We can see this truth by observing the regions not under control by the national army. The first thrust of the revolution was against religion, which, if it is in every civilization and in every people, still had in Spain a social character unsurpassed by any other. Religion is the support of all civilizations, what gives them their strength and nuance. The Catholic religion is the form of our civilization, and it was here that the thrust of our enemies was mainly directed. And with the suffering of religion comes the suffering of all else.

Never in the history of any people has there been such a cumulation of horrors as Spain has witnessed in these four months. Thousands of priests and religious have succumbed, among them ten Bishops, sometimes amid unheard-of shames and torments. The priest is the "man of God"; to annihilate God, those who call themselves "godless" and "against God" had to eliminate their representatives from society. When the world knows it, because today it is still a secret hidden in the non-reconquered regions, this hecatomb of the Lord's anointed will cause horror.

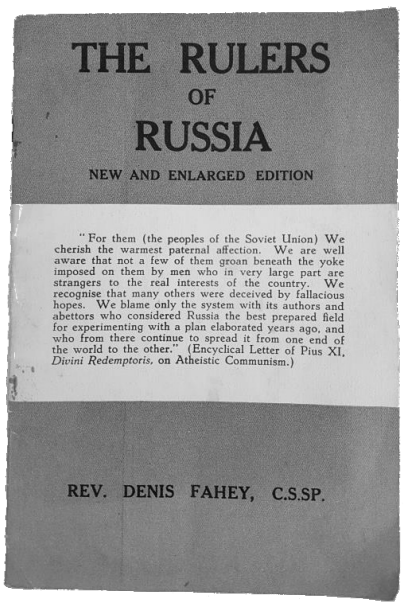
With the "ministers of God" have suffered the "houses of God". Innumerable churches, many of them the pride of art, synthesis of our history, all loaded with the jewels of piety that the centuries accumulated in them, living centers of the traditional faith of our peoples, have been burned and destroyed to the ground. Spanish art has suffered irreparable damage as famous works have disappeared from our temples, with which it would still have been possible to form the best collection in the world.

The destruction of libraries and archives, the profanation of sepulchres, the outrages against virgins consecrated to God, the slaughter of innocent children, the forms of the most repugnant ferocity in the thousands of murders committed, the sacrilegious instinct that has guided these men without God or law in the destruction of the most representative of our Christian religion, especially the venerable images of Jesus Christ and Holy Mary, have given the inhuman note of this explosion of bastard passions that have lashed Spanish society since the war broke out.

And along with it, this decapitation of the Christian general staff, these massacres of qualified "right-wingers", that is, conspicuous Christians, heads of religious institutions of all kinds, who have succumbed in their thousands with no other crime than the profession of the faith of their elders and their works of apostolate, with no other judgment than the whim of the enemies of our Christian organizations.

Republican fighters "executing" Our Lord by firing squad circa 1935. Curiously, the international republican volunteer force was composed of around 25% jews: a figure vastly disproportionate to their number of the world population.

> "The first thrust of the revolution was against this great fact of Religion, which, if it is in every civilization and in every people, still had in Spain a social exponent unsurpassed by any other. Religion is the support of all civilizations, what gives them their strength and nuance."



THE RULERS OF RUSSIA

NEW AND ENLARGED EDITION

"For them (the peoples of the Soviet Union) We cherish the warmest paternal affection. We are well aware that not a few of them groan beneath the yoke imposed on them by men who in very large part are strangers to the real interests of the country. We recognise that many others were deceived by fallacious hopes. We blame only the system with its authors and abettors who considered Russia the best prepared field for experimenting with a plan elaborated years ago, and who from there continue to spread it from one end of the world to the other." (Encyclical Letter of Pius XI, *Divini Redemptoris*, on Atheistic Communism.)

REV. DENIS FAHEY, C.S.SP.

Father Fahey laid out in his book *The Rulers of Russia*, that the spirit and personnel behind the bolshevik revolution in Russia, was not native to Russia but largely a foreign jewish enterprise.

Let us not omit a terrible fact; the systematic destruction of wealth, private and national, and its sources. Wealth is strength and bond in every social and political system. It was, with all the defects of our economic setup, of traditional Spain. It was necessary to destroy it, and even more so in the Marxist or communist conception of the State, which has no more philosophy or soul or value than material wealth. Hence the systematic and immense spoliation we have suffered. Private and public wealth, as much as possible, has passed into the hands of the leaders.

See the fact: abolition of private property, confiscation of property, intervention of accounts, sovietization of exploitations and industries, alienation of the gold deposits of the State, systematic persecution —murder, not infrequently—of the leaders of large industries, and the destruction of immense treasures of art. Thus, one of its strong supports has been removed from the old regime; thus, with the gaps opened by personal ambition filled, an enormous stream can be poured into the coffers of the future Bolshevik state.

And thus the soul and body of Spain have been undone, as much as has been within the intention of the revolutionaries.

Let us give to the claudication of authority, to the ignorance of the masses, to the exacerbation produced by the phenomenon of war, to the spirit of revenge and plunder all that corresponds to them as causes of the dreadful hecatomb. Even exaggerating

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Cardinal Gomá's Support of Franco Cont.

Hitler was the quickest and most generous in response to Franco's pleas for aid to protect Spain and her Catholic traditions against the communist threat. Pictured above: The Condor Legion of the Third Reich provided the majority of Franco's air support.

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them, they will not equal the effect produced. What has caused this subversion of the Christian spirit in our country and has made the catastrophe possible has been the tenacious work of several years of inoculation of foreign doctrines in the soul of the people; the impious legislation, determined by the pressure of the secret societies of international character; the proselytism of Moscow, aided by the stream of gold that incessantly arrived in Spain, producing the prevarication of the leaders and the perversion of the masses; the fascinating mystique of exotic communism.

It has been the Tartar soul, the genius of communist internationalism that has supplanted the Christian sense of a large part of our people and has launched it with frenzy against the Spain that, forged in the Councils of Toledo and strengthened in its struggles against the enemies of its faith, had reached three centuries ago the highest peaks to which a nation can aspire, and that still retained the fragrance of its essences in the depths of the national soul.

Therefore, under penalty of our homeland succumbing without remedy, the moment had to arrive for the clash between the two Spains, which we would better call the two civilizations: that of Russia, which is nothing more than a form of barbarism, and the Christian one, of which Spain had been in past centuries honor and pride and an invincible defender.

This is what the struggle represents on Spanish soil, stained with the blood of brothers, it is true, but rather the theater of a war in which old Spain withstands the storm unleashed upon it by this international barbarism called communism.

As I write these lines, while thousands of soldiers from the steppes of Russia disembark in Barcelona, along with copious war material, a Barcelona Kremlin is being established, a branch of the Russian Komitern, head of the Soviet Republic of the Mediterranean and center of Bolshevization of the Western European countries. The project that, by a very special providence of God, could not be carried out in Madrid, capital of Spain, has been realized in the beautiful and unfortunate capital of the Catalan region. It is the demonstration of our thesis. As much as is within the intention of Moscow, the communist flag has been planted in Spain opposite its most Christian flag. Here the two civilizations have clashed, the two antithetical forms of social life. Christ and the Antichrist are battling on our soil.

The Spanish people have been accused, as always, of being fanatical. The fratricidal struggle, placed on religious grounds, would be due to the intransigence of some against the intransigence of others. The calumny has even reached the army, with some foreign newspapers claiming that Protestant temples have been destroyed and victims caused among those who do not profess the Catholic religion. Shouldn't there have been some of the latter, when the red militias and their rearguard count thousands of Europeans of every country and religion?

The fantasy of the informers, here and outside of Spain, has invented terrible tales to discredit the religious sentiment of our people. From abroad, we have been asked for information on this point, to vindicate the name of Catholic Spain. It is not necessary. Whoever accuses must prove. Not a single fact will be demonstrated that imputes to the national army a crime for religious reasons. If there were any, it should be attributed to a particular error or to a reprehensible zeal.

But no; not even this; the war is against those who take up arms in favor of Marxist materialism, corrosive of all the pieces of the magnificent framework of Western civilization, and combat the Christian spirit and that of homeland, of hierarchy and respect, without which Europe and Spain would go back twenty centuries in their history.

The Spanish Army and The Red Front

One more observation. In this culminating moment of the war in Spain, we are allowed to observe this phenomenon of internationalism that we denounce, not only in the underground current of the spiritual movement of these last years and that has produced this bloody explosion; not even in the way in which the warring armies and the respective sectors of opinion that they represent conduct themselves, but in the very battlefields.

Adventurous people from all over Europe have come to Spain to wage war against the national army. A Russian general is the one who manages the most powerful nucleus of the communist army. Russian rag-and-bone men are the ones who have directed the plunder of our works of art, especially in our Cathedral of Toledo. Russians are, these days, the ones who have raised with revolutionary harangues, in the meeting and on the radio, the spirit of the Marxist armies. Technicians from all countries, recruited in the Popular Fronts or in the Soviet armies, are the ones who direct the defense works of the battle fronts. The cries of "Long live Russia!" and "Long live Russian Spain!" are, to our confusion and shame, a worthy conclusion with which the speakers close their speeches in the revolutionary assemblies, which are followed by the notes of the Internationale, a slow and cold hymn, as if of northern origin, in contrast to those of the Riego hymn, which once shook the soul of the small national revolutionaries. And as Balkanization, that is, the political division of nations, is a tactic that pleases internationalist communism, in Spain the phenomenon of this series of small republics or Soviet states has already occurred, which, if a prudent and wise military and Spanish hand did not reduce them to the just molds of national unity, would be the best way to reach the definitive decomposition of our homeland.

It is the demonstration, to the face of the world, of the internationalism of today's war in Spain. Sustained with the traditional valor of our soldiers and carried out with the honor that is the hallmark of our arms and that has its expression and its guarantee in the generalissimo of the national armies, we believe that, as in other times, this war can be the salvation of Europe, even if our nation, which by its very geographical situation has had to be the castle of defense of the outposts of the old continent, remains bled dry and impoverished in the contest.

It will not be the first time that Spain carries its forehead at once withered by pain and haloed by glory; she who knew how to contain with raw effort the invasions from the south and remain unharmed by the heresies from the north; who bled to light up for civilization and for Jesus Christ a New World; she, who has engendered sacrifice and birthed glorious heroes like those of Tarifa and the Toledo Alcázar.

Who knows if the heroic gesture of our Spain, which has taken from the reliquary of its soul and from the old coffers of its history the faith and the weapons that are today the admiration of the world, anticipated the tragic, destructive gesture prepared by Moscow's diplomacy against Western Europe! Who knows if the surgical operation, extremely bloody, that is being performed in our country, a member of Europe, will be the remedy that expels from the body of the old continent the pestiferous humor that has it in grave danger! The signs in the heavens allow us to foresee the storms; there is no lack of signs of bad weather in the skies of Europe. And Spain is the nation of great destinies.

May God grant that we make ourselves worthy of them. Men move, and God directs them. His will triumphs over all weapons, and before the diplomacy of his inscrutable designs on the human world, all the projects and combinations of the chancellories are houses of cards.

Let us learn…

In closing these considerations, our priestly character and our inextinguishable love for Spain authorize Us to formulate some exhortations of a moral and social nature.

To the Spanish people, we say to pray to God that His will, which is to save us, be done in us.

May the tremendous social iniquity we have witnessed not weigh more heavily in the scales of His justice than the heroic sacrifice of the blood of His martyrs and soldiers, who have given it abundantly and generously in defense of the great ideals of religion and homeland.

"May the tremendous social iniquity we have witnessed not weigh more heavily in the scales of His justice than the heroic sacrifice of the blood of His martyrs and soldiers, who have given it abundantly and generously in defense of the great ideals of religion and homeland."

If it is in His inscrutable designs that the national should surpass the international, giving our armies victory on the battlefields, let us know how to take advantage of the benefit of victory so that in the old Spain, painfully tilled by the hard plow of war, we can sow the seed of the new, great, and Christian Spain that we all dream of today, as one dreams of the heritage to be bequeathed to one's children.

And for this, may He give us the spirit of concord that casts the effort of all in the mold of a single ideal and polarizes thoughts and hearts in the sense of the great and immortal Spain. It will not be so if it does not become deeply Christian again.

Let us correct ourselves. In denouncing the main factor that, in our judgment, has produced the tremendous current conflagration in Spain, we did not want to point out the national vices that have gradually made our homeland easy prey for communism. No one suddenly becomes good or bad. Vices of constitution or gradual infections are the slippery slope down which one goes to ruin and death.

To indicate those of our race and of our social customs is not for this place. We wanted only to rule, according to our judgment, on the immediate cause of the disaster. The forgetting of our tradition and history; the itch, already two centuries old, to slavishly copy what is outside, in letters, laws, and customs; the misunderstanding of the problems of each moment; the inconstancy of political situations; the plebeian sense of our democracies; the farce of parliamentarianism and the lie of suffrage; the lack of formation of a national consciousness and the disorientation in the international sphere; opportunism and favoritism in politics; the morbidity of particularistic nationalisms and their opposite of a grid-like State, unaware of the contours and reliefs of the national body: all this could be chapters of a book on our decadence.

Add to this our rigid economic structure, which has not wanted to bend one iota to the drive of the forces of a proletariat mis-

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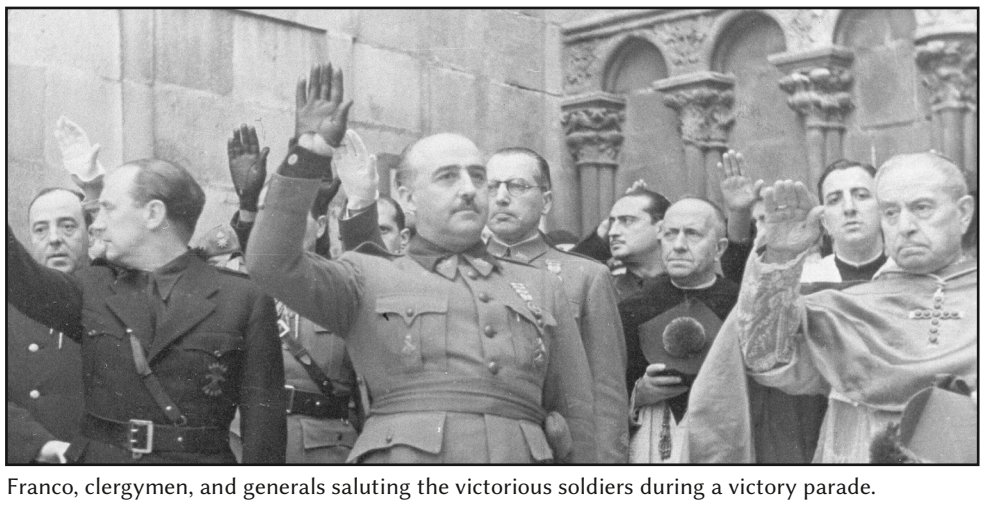

Franco, clergymen, and generals saluting the victorious soldiers during a victory parade.

Cardinal Gomá's Support of Franco Cont.

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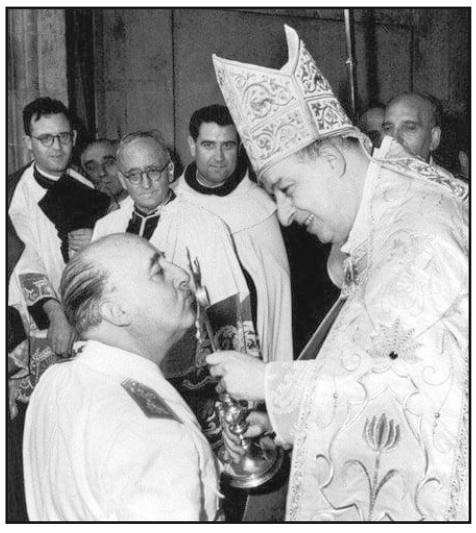
matched with that of the rest of Europe, at least in our fields, making it easy prey for paradisiacal preachings; the lack of adaptation, activity, and strategy in our own priestly apostolate; the enervating corruption of customs; the other corruption, perhaps worse, of thought by the crazy freedoms of the lectern, tribune, and press; the extremely defective formation of popular consciousness on the problems of social life and the duties they entail; and, above all, the lack of political authority, perhaps the most serious problem of our national life. Selfishness and rivalries have systematically cornered men of worth, while ambition and audacity have raised on the shield others with scant talent, who, if they have lacked the head and fist for the needs of a paternal and severe government at the same time, have been magnificent pawns of an internationalism that is the antithesis of our racial spirit

Let us cure ourselves of our ills, of a personal and social nature. They are no greater than those of other peoples; rather, we believe that they are curable with the tenacity of an intelligent effort, and that in the substance of our national idiosyncrasy, the leaders of the people, in all the chromaticity of a wisely exercised authority, could find resources to rebuild a State emulating our past greatness.



Franco venerating a relic (1960).

And to foreigners who want to hear us and who today contemplate, curious or interested, the chessboard of Spain on which perhaps the fate of civilized Europe is being played, we recommend the utmost serenity in judging the events of our country. It is difficult to sift the truth through information from a biased press or from age-old prejudices. The history of each moment is woven with the thread with which the fabric of the past was woven; and it is necessary to penetrate the spiritual process of a people to give us reason for the present phenomenon, especially if it is as extraordinary as the current one in Spain.

To the leaders, to those who exercise high magistracies, we say the words of the Prophet: "Learn, you who rule over peoples." Learn to keep them immune from all spiritual contagion that could pervert them or throw them off the routes of their genius or their history.

Do not allow the strength of God, which is the immortal vigor of all things, to be weakened in them. Do not compromise with evil, not even under the guise of the demands of social freedom; to grant it the rights of citizenship, and even more so to admit it into the sanctuary of the laws, will be to agree to the ruin, in the more or less long term, of the people you lead.

In the ruins of Spain, see, more than the destructive work of the cannons, the senseless work of rulers who did not know how to govern the Spanish people; who did not interpret their soul and their history. They opened the floodgates of communism, which invaded us like the waters of a broken dam, and from the mixture of the national with the exotic has resulted the tremendous conflagration. Hear the voice of the Pope, who recently pointed out to you the universal danger and the eternal remedy, which can be none other than Jesus Christ and the spirit of his Gospel.

And to our sister nations, to those who grieve for our ills, to those who run the same dangers as us, we say, take heed from the example of Spain. Don't think you are immune to the evil that has plagued the soul of our people and put it in a death trance: every society is a breeding ground in which communism will proliferate if God, who is the life and bond of spirits, is absent, and the authority that emanates from Him, which is the guarantee of justice and social order; and God and authority are in crisis today in almost all nations.

We have read strange things about the Spanish revolution. The Spanish warlike temperament; their ardent blood, like that of a race bordering Africa; the anxieties of an atavism that has failed to fuse the complex soul of the old civilizations that flourished in Iberia, Romans and Goths, Jews and Arabs who mingled without merging into a spiritual bloc; the centrifugal force of nationalism that tends to destroy the national whole; the spirit of chivalrous adventure that translates into the gesture of some generals who have "pronounced" themselves throughout our history, producing these periodic hecatombs marked by the names of famous captains… All this explains, they say, the rare phenomenon of a civil war that is displaced from modern history.

No, we respond. Our war has not been caused by our temperament or our history, even recognizing all the defects of our race and our social life; but it is the product of the clash with a foreign temperament, with factors that wanted to throw us off the path of our history.

"There is no sin that one man can commit that another man cannot commit if He by whom man was made is absent," says Saint Augustine. And there is no nation, we add, glossing over this great principle of ascetics, in which the deplorable experience of Spain cannot be repeated, if God is removed from its entrails and replaced by the materialism of the godless or against God.

This is what has happened to us because of our uncorrected defects, because of the passivity of those who should have watched over the preserve in which we peacefully lived our history, and because of the irruption into it, stealthily at first, with the resources and prestige of authority, later, and then with the militias and war machines, when the time had come to seize by violence the fruit matured by an enormous effort of proselytism and by the effectiveness of anti-Spanish laws. Only the old spirit of Spain arose, which also had its armies and arsenals. And the war broke out, without the need for other fantasies to explain it.

"In the ruins of Spain, see, more than the destructive work of the cannons, the senseless work of rulers who did not know how to govern the Spanish people; who did not interpret their soul and their history."

Let the nations and those who lead them learn. And let us, Spaniards, learn this harsh lesson, which enters us with the blood of thousands of brothers, in the sinister light of the fires and amid the crackling of war machines and the cities that collapse.

Cardinal Gomá y Tomás shows us how the virtue of patriotism is in no way opposed to the proper worship of God. In our modern time, Catholics are presented a false dichotomy: prefer your own country and want the best for it, and be in opposition to the love of God. Love God above all else, and necessarily abandon the natural affection for one's own people. This dichotomy is engineered and propogated by the Church's enemies, in order to weaken and conquer the Christian nations for satan.

In truth, these two loves of God and nation are not incompatible, but rather they are mutual, provided the love of God is not subordinated to the other—not dissimimlar to how one can love their own family and God together. May laymen realise this truth and may it motivate us to form ordered societies in our respective national homelands for the glory of Jesus Christ our King.

A Captive of Conscience

Young Man of Character

Bishop Tihamer Toth

From the book The Young Man of Character*, published in 1936.*

A captive of conscience. It sounds like the title of a mystery story, you may think. Wrong. The greatest compliment we can give a young man is to say: He is lord of his will and captive of his conscience. Consistently and uncompromisingly faithful to the dictates of your conscience: if you are capable of this, you are a young man of character.

Every wagon has a small nail in it, barely noticeable: the linchpin. It is a locking pin inserted in the end of the axle to prevent the wheel from slipping off. If it falls out, the wagon goes on for a while more, then the wheel slips off and the wagon turns over. On the path of virtue you can find a comparable little thing. It is unconditional adherence to the word of your conscience. So be an obedient servant of your conscience.

There are two enemies fighting against your conscience. The whole world around you speaks against it; and your disordered inclinations and awakening instincts entice you to folly.

Once in a while you have ardent moments, you seem to have left the earth and soar in the pure heights. You are determined always to follow your conscience. You will never deviate from the road of honor. You will never commit sin, in thought, word or deed. You feel happy, good and light. And what next? This mate of yours or that does not keep God's commandments. Your noble principles are ridiculed in this book or in that play or movie. And then comes the hardest trial! If the whole world is bad, can you remain good? If the whole school consists of dishonorable boys, can you still remain faithful to your noble principles? If everybody is lying, but you, never! If all the boys miss their Sunday Mass, but you, never! If their language is filthy, but yours, never!

Then there comes yet another trial. There is an enemy not on the outside, but on the inside, in your own being. Conscience is called the word of God, and justly. Who has not heard it? When he was tempted to fight, a warning was heard like a little bell: Don't do it! Don't do it! When he was tempted to take something belonging to another he again heard the warning. And when he encountered an even more serious temptation, the warning bell was loudly crying: Don't do it! Don't do it!

I ask you again, my son, to train yourself in your youth to listen to the voice of your conscience unconditionally. This will determine whether you will become a conscientious man. The conscientious man is the pillar of society on whom everything rests.

> A man's word is good protection,
> A man's action is better advice.
> The best protection and advice
> Is a man of his word and deed.
> —Rückert

Whoever is the captive of his conscience, he is the captive of God, and being a captive of God is the greatest freedom. I cannot imagine a greater compliment than the one received by an English MP who died young: the Ten Commandments stamped His whole being.

Be afraid of nothing except your conscience! It is not upright to abandon anything that your conscience prescribes because you are afraid that others will disparage or ridicule you. If you are afraid of praying openly or of genuflecting in church because "others will see it" you are not a captive of your own conscience, but a captive of a cowardly fear of men. Aldous Huxley (1894-1963) was right when he wrote: "True manliness means strong will guided by a gentle conscience." You have no will power and your character is undeveloped if you always fearfully watch what others might say. And you have no strong character if you follow your heart but ignore your intellect, if you prefer pleasant desires to strict duty.

> Don't ask your heart what it desires,
> Ask your conscience about your duty.
> —F. W. Weber

The Persian rulers tried to guarantee a good sleep for themselves by hiding several talents of gold (representing a huge amount of money) in their pillow. The Roman emperor Caligula added wild animals to his palace guard to make sure nobody disturbed his rest. Artemon placed a large shield over his head for protection in case the building should collapse. All for nothing! The best way to guarantee a good sleep is to have a good conscience:

> A good conscience is the gentlest pillow to sleep on.
> Be the ruler of your will and captive of your conscience!

Saint Peter of Verona (Saint Peter Martyr) was killed with a dagger. After the first stabs he cried: "Credo! I believe!" When he could not speak any more, he dipped his fingers in his own blood and wrote on the ground: "Credo!" He was a man of character, a captive of his own conscience.

A History of Charlemagne

A Popular Account of The Grandfather of Europe

Robert Williams

Charles the Great, or Charlemagne *was king of the Franks, a nation of the Germanic race who dwelt in the north west of modern day Germany and the north east of modern day France. He expanded his Kingdom greatly, to the point where it encompassed almost the entirety of Western Europe. This culminated in his coronation as the Emporer of the Roman Empire by Pope Leo III. Charlemagne is considered the grandfather of Europe: he promoted the cause of the Christian religion in his empire, promoted the founding of learning institutions, and repelled the Saracens from Christian lands.*

This account of his history is from the introduction of The History of Charlemagne*, published in 1907, which translates several of the contemporaneous chronicles into English.*

To the eye of the historian, the grandeur of Charlemagne is entirely confined to the position he maintains in the history of the world. In the slow transit and gradual transformation of the old world of classical antiquity into the world with which men of today deal, no man played a greater part than Charlemagne. He stands, as it were, at the meeting point of the ages where ancient history ends and modern history begins. The centuries of the Middle Ages before him record the decline and fall of many an old institution hoary with age and ready to vanish away ; and the centuries after him, up to the Renaissance and the Reformation, record the preparation for, and the introduction of, those institutions which have been both factors and products of modern history. Charlemagne is the great central figure of the Middle Ages, who, by arresting the drift of the corrupt and disintegrating forces then prevalent among nations rude in manners and undisciplined in mind, became the creator of Modern Europe.

When Charles ascended his father's throne, the Roman Empire had been, for more than three centuries, slowly dying. In A.D. 410, it received a death-blow when Rome was captured and sacked by the West Goths under their King Alaric. Before the long process of disintegration of the great world-empire was finished, the world was startled by the appearance of a great and warlike Semitic power which is associated with the name and faith of Mohammed. In 622, Mohammed escaped from the holy city of Mecca, where he was born in 569, and came to Medina, "the city of the prophet". In this retreat of his is seen the beginning of his career of spiritual conquest. From the first he taught that his faith was to be forced upon all men by the sword. So the Arabs, or Saracens as they are also called, as soon as they embraced the faith of Mohammed, held it to be their part and duty to spread their faith everywhere, which in fact meant to conquer the whole world.[1] Everywhere they went, they gave men the choice of three things, *Koran, tribute,* or *sword*; that is, they called upon all men either to believe in Mohammed and to accept the Koran, to submit to the rule of the Saracens and pay tribute, or to fight against them, and if conquered to be put to death by the sword. Before the death of Mohammed in 632, the career of Saracen conquest had begun. Before the end of the seventh century, Syria, Persia, Egypt, and North Africa had been conquered and made subject to the rule of the Caliph. In 711 the followers of the Prophet crossed over into Europe from Africa and conquered the whole of Spain with the exception of the mountain fastnesses of the North, where the Christians held their own. They crossed the Pyrenees and conquered a part of Gaul, i.e., the province of Narbonne. They came as far as Autun, which is but one hundred and eighty miles from Paris. However, this was the extreme point of their conquests in Western Europe. In 732, they were defeated by Charles Martel, the grandfather of Charlemagne, in the battle of Tours. Nevertheless, Narbonne was still in their power and possession when Charlemagne was born. This Saracen occupation of a part of the soil of Frankland continued till the foreign invaders were finally driven out of Gaul by Charlemagne's father, Pepin, in 739.

In the east of Europe, the Avars, a Turanian people, continually menaced the lands of Italy and Illyria. They occupied the region between the Danube where had been the seat of the old barbaric kingdom of Attila.

The lands between the lower Rhine and the Elbe were inhabited by the barbarous and heathen Saxons. These people represented the Teutonic spirit and temper in its fiercest and most stubborn and uncompromising mood, and thus they presented, possibly, the most formidable obstacle to that re-modelling of Europe according to Charlemagne's own liking.

Charlemagne was born in the year 742, and succeeded his father Pepin as king of the Franks in 768. He was crowned emperor of the Romans in 800 and died in 814, after an eventful reign of forty-six years. His father had divided the Frankish kingdom between him and his younger brother, Carloman. But the latter died in 771, and Charlemagne was proclaimed with one accord the sole king of the Franks.[2]

The kingdom Charlemagne thus inherited was a very extensive one. For in addition to the Frankish territory extending from the Loire to the Rhine, other countries such as Burgundy and Alemania had been incorporated into it, while almost all around his empire were grouped many vassal states. Aquitaine, Brittany, Frisia, Thuringia, and Bavaria, were to a more or less degree under the sway of the king of the Franks. He was, further, the hereditary protector of the Pope against Creeks and Lombards, and the champion of the Christian faith against the Saracens on the south-west and the heathen Saxons on the northwest. In fact, when Charlemagne took up the sceptre, when it fell from his father's hand, the Franks had obtained a real supremacy over most of the Germanic people, and were rightly regarded as the bulwark of Christianity in the west.

Such, briefly, was the aspect of affairs when Charlemagne found himself the controller of the destinies of Western Europe.

The many-sided and lofty position of a king among the Franks then imposed a corresponding complexity of duty on the new king. This Charlemagne fulfilled with an energy and success almost unexampled in the history of the world. He maintained and extended on all hands the influence of Christian culture, and took the first steps towards converting the military monarchy of the Franks into an organized and highly civilized state.

The keynote of his reign is the alliance of the temporal power with the national church in Frankland and with the universal church as represented by the Roman See. He endeavoured to expand his power to the utmost bounds consistent with stability, and within those bounds to diffuse that form of faith and culture which had been long preparing within the bosom of the Frankish church. He had an idea of one universal State, of one prodigious political unity. He wished to form one Christian Europe in the political and social unity of the Empire, and in the spiritual unity of the Church. Reverence for Rome was still strong in the minds of men. So the Papacy was definitely planted at the head of Christianity. He would remodel Europe after the likeness of the old Roman empire. "The resurrection of the Roman empire was the favourite contemplation and dream of Charlemagne."[3] He would resuscitate the form, but not the spirit, of the old. What would have realized his highest aspiration would be the establishment of one vast empire, after the model of the old Roman empire, but infused with the spirit of Christianity, with the emperor of Rome as the centre of the political unity, and the bishop of Rome as the centre of the spiritual unity. The march of Christianity would then both favour and follow the expansion of his empire. His father Pepin had an idea of this kind in his mind when he cultivated the friendship of the Pope and was made patrician of Rome and patron of the Holy See. But he lacked the fiery spirit and magnetic personality which gained for Charlemagne the enthusiastic devotion of his own countrymen and even of conquered nations.

> "He maintained and extended on all hands the influence of Christian culture, and took the first steps towards converting the military monarchy of the Franks into an organized and highly civilized state."

Charlemagne's first task as supreme commander of the Frankish forces was to suppress a rising in Aquitaine in 769. This duchy, after Charles Martel had saved it from the Saracens, continued, as of old, to be one of the most troublesome of the Frankish dependencies.[4] This suppression was carried out by Charlemagne single-handed, as his brother Carloman, whose territories were unaffected by the result, refused to lend him his aid.

In 772 Charlemagne commenced the great mission of his life—the conquest and conversion of the Saxons, a work which could only be effected after thirty-two years of the most fierce and most passionate warfare.[5] The Saxons were, with the doubtful exception of the Frisians, the last remnant of the old Germanic resistance to the military supremacy of the Franks, and the last Germanic champions of the religion of Odin against the onward progress of Christianity.

The encroachment of the Saxons on his eastern frontier was the occasion of his first expedition. Charlemagne invaded the land and destroyed all he met by fire and by sword. He stormed the castle of Eresburg and took it. He overthrew the idol which the Saxons called Irminsul, and destroyed the sanctuary of Odin, and compelled the Westphalian Saxons to submit.[6]

Pope Hadrian, oppressed by the Lombards and their king Desiderius, summoned Charlemagne to the other side of the Alps.[7] The Saxons, regarding the absence of the king as a most favourable occasion, renewed their old ravages. On his return, Charlemagne set out against them, and in two campaigns enforced the submission of the entire Saxon confederation.[8] In the great Champ-de- Mai, at Pederborn, the Frankish king, surrounded by his chiefs and by ambassadors from other nations, received the homage of the Saxon warriors (except that of Witikind), and many thousands of them were baptized on that occasion.

In 778 Charlemagne crossed the Pyrenees, and secured the submission of the country as far as the Ebro. On his return his rearguard was assailed and cut off by mountaineers in the pass of Roncesvalles, and this overthrow of the Franks became eventually one of the great themes of song and romance, of which more will be said in another chapter. His march home from

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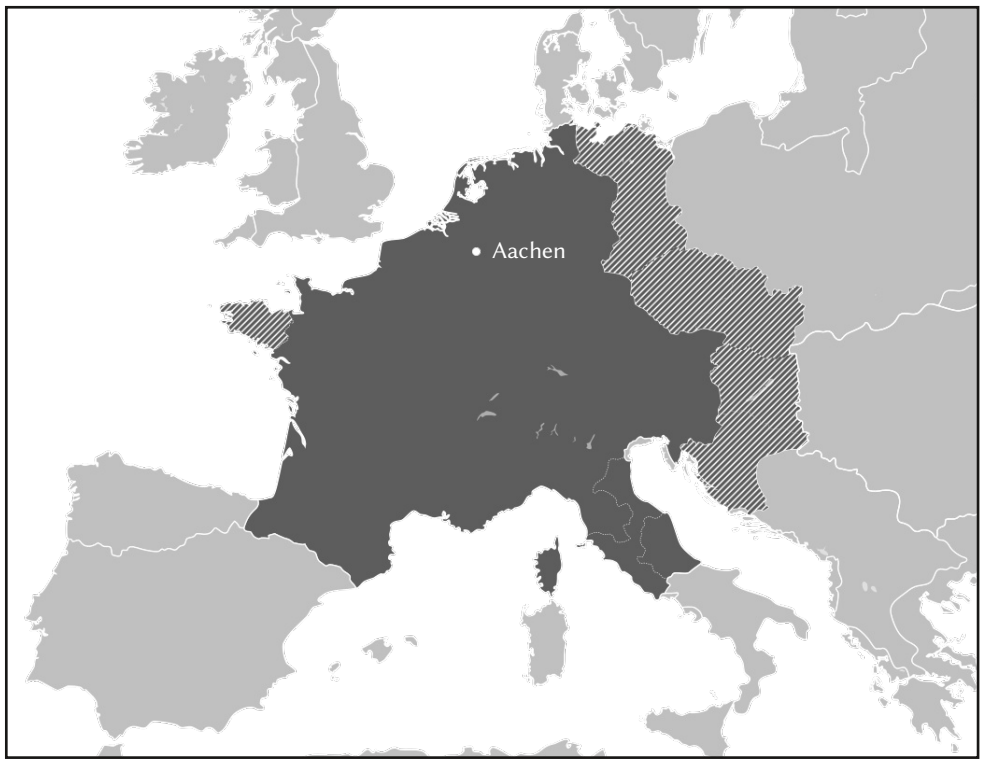

The Frankish Empire at it's greatest expanse in 814. The striped territory are those regions which were under tribute, while the shaded part was ruled directly by Charlemagne. Aachen was where Charles held his court. Today, Aachen lies within the confines of modern-day Germany, closely bordering on Belgium.

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Spain was hastened by the general revolt of the Saxons, assisted this time by the Danes. Charlemagne was again easily victorious. But no sooner had he left the country than the Saxons were again up in arms. Even the massacre of four thousand five hundred prisoners who fell into the king's hands, and who were beheaded at his command, at Werden, served only to intensify the spirit of resistance.[9] They were again completely defeated. Even Witikind, the hero of the whole war, was compelled to submit to Charlemagne, and received baptism at Attigny. Many followed his example. But it was not until 804 that the last spark of the resistance was quenched.

The result of this war was that Charles was left the sole master of the lands which, taken together, made up mediaeval Germany. By imposing upon the inhabitants of these lands a common ecclesiastical and secular administration, by subjecting them to one allegiance and one faith, he imparted to this mighty mass of people a political unity which was never to be destroyed. In this sense he is to be regarded as the creator of the German nation.[10]

When Charlemagne had brought the war in Aquitaine to a successful end, at the request of Hadrian, the bishop of Rome, he entered into war against the Lombards.[11]

In 757 Desiderius, duke of Tuscany, became the king of the Lombards. In 770 Charlemagne put away his wife, a noble Frankish lady, and, at the request of his mother, married a daughter of Desiderius. The marriage tie was soon broken.[12] After a year's wedlock the daughter of Desiderius was back again in her father's court a divorced and rejected wife. Naturally this did not improve the relations between Desiderius and Charlemagne.

In 772, Hadrian ascended the pontifical throne. The new Pope wished to follow the policy of his immediate predecessors in cultivating the friendship of the king of the Franks, and consequently he turned a deaf ear to the demands made by Desiderius that he should anoint the infant sons of Carloman as kings of the Franks. Desiderius resolved to march on Rome with all his army and compel the Pope at the point of the sword to carry out his wish. He seized some of the cities of Italy and approached the frontiers of the duchy of Rome. Hadrian still refused, and called upon Desiderius to restore the possessions which he had taken from the See of Rome. He also sent a legate to Charlemagne with an earnest request for help, reminding the king of the oath he had taken as a patrician to defend the See of Rome. Desiderius also sent ambassadors who told a different story. Charlemagne resolved to make inquiries into the case. As a result he offered to the king of the Lombards fourteen thousand golden solidi (£8,000) if he would restore the conquered cities, and so satisfy the demands made by Hadrian. This he refused to do.

Charlemagne summoned his army and set out for Italy. He renewed his offer of money payment. This offer was again refused. The time had come to appeal to the sword. The army crossed over to Lombardy, one half of them by Mont Cenis and the other half by the Great St Bernard. Desiderius awaited their coming at Susa, which was regarded then as the key of Italy. The Lombards fled at the approach of the Franks. Soon Pa via and Verona were besieged. Charlemagne arrived in Rome on the eve of Easter Sunday. It was the first occasion on which he had seen the city of the Caesars. To the Romans the Frankish patrician represented the old Imperial governors of Italy, whose title he had taken.[13] His entry was, therefore, celebrated with all the pomp and circumstance formerly reserved for the Caesars. In June 774, the gates of Pavia, after having been besieged for ten months, were opened to Charlemagne, and the dominion of the Lombards in Italy came to a perpetual end.

The expedition into Spain is the theme of many a stirring song sung by the minstrels of old in all the countries of Europe. What is the true history of this episode? Why did Charlemagne enter Spain? What was his motive? Why should he interfere with and molest the Saracens since Frankland had so little to fear from them?

The biographer of Louis the Pious suggests that the king desired to help the Christians in Spain. Hadrian had impressed upon Charlemagne's mind that his peculiar mission was to fight the heathen. Legend confirms this suggestion. The romance of the pseudo Turpin tells us that Charlemagne entered Spain at the wish of St. James to deliver Galice from the power of the Saracens.[14] But is this historically true? In order to understand the part played by Charles at this juncture, it is necessary to glance for a moment at the condition of the Mohammedan world, and more particularly of the Moors in Spain.

For a hundred years the Ommayad Caliphs, in a long line, had governed the vast regions which owned the faith of Mohammed. The Caliph, as the successor of the Prophet, wielded a power religious as well as military. He was at once Pope and King of the Saracen world. It was in the name of the Ommayad Caliph and by his lieutenants that Spain was conquered; in his name Gaul was invaded by those swarming myriads whom Charles Martel with difficulty repulsed in the great battle of Tours. But in the year 750, eighteen years before the accession of Charlemagne there had come a change. The unity of Islamism was broken, and the divisions that then crept in, even more than the sword of Charles Martel, saved Europe from Moslem domination. The Ommayad Caliphs, who reigned at Damascus had forgotten, in the delights and luxurious life of that city, some of the stern simplicity of their earlier predecessors. A new and more austere claimant to their religious throne presented himself in the person of Abul Abbas, who was descended from an uncle of the Prophet, and the old feud between the two tribes of the Koreish and Haschimites flared up into a fierce civil war, the reigning Ommayads belonging to the former, and the revolting Abbasides to the latter class.

In the battle of Mosul (750) the Abbasides gained the upper hand; Merwan, the last Ommayad caliph, fled to Egypt, where he was slain, and a bloody massacre of the eighty Ommayads at a banquet, all but completed the ruin of the family. From the overthrow of a princely race, one only escaped. The young Abderrahman, son of Merwan, fled from Syria, and after many adventures and many narrow escapes, ever travelling westward, reached the tents of a tribe of Bedouins in Morocco, with whom he claimed kinship through his mother. Here he was gladly granted the asylum which he so much needed. While he was sharing their hospitality there came an embassy from some of the chief Mussulmans of Spain to offer him the supreme power in that country. The various Emirs who had been misgoverning that unhappy land for forty years since the Moorish conquest had given it neither prosperity nor peace; possibly also there was a feeling that they had failed as champions of Mohammedism against Christianity. At any rate, there was a strong desire to try what unity and concentration under a resident and independent sovereign would accomplish, and for this purpose to take advantage of the presence of a high-spirited and courageous youth, the descendant of a long line of sovereigns. The invitation was gladly accepted. Abderrahman crossed into Spain in 755 and won victory after victory over the representatives of his Abbaside foe, the chief of whom was named Yussuf-el-Fekr, and though he himself did not assume the title of Caliph, virtually he *founded the Caliphate of Cordova*, which for nearly three hundred years, often with brilliant success, guided the fortune and destiny of Mohammedan Spain.

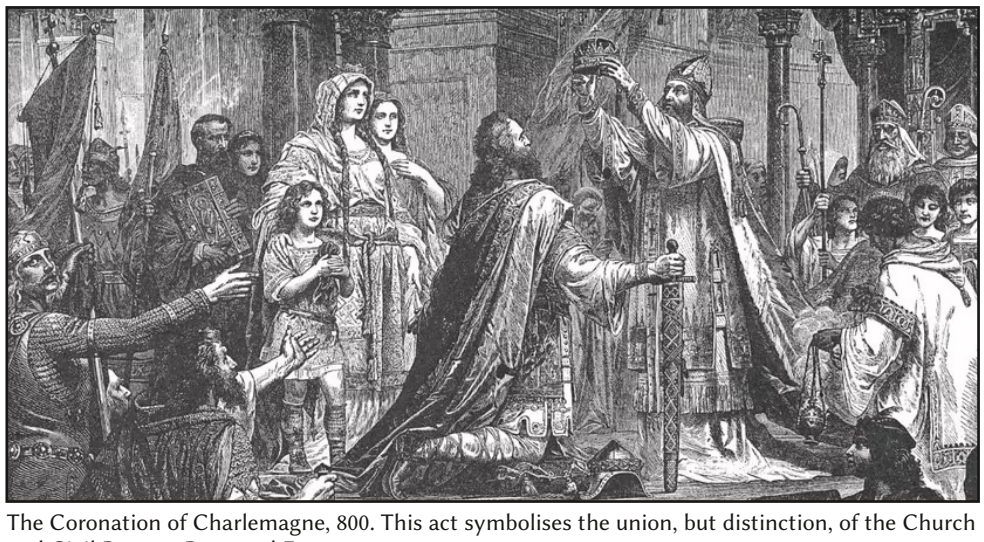
But Abderrahman, though deservedly one of the favourite heroes of Saracen literature, did not win supreme power in Spain without a hard struggle, and even after he had conquered, there was many a fresh outbreak of opposition to his rule. Though Yussuf-el- Fekr fell in battle (759), his sons filled the next twenty years with turmoil. And it was one of these sons and a son-in-law of Yussuf, who, together with Jbu-el-Arabi (possibly the Governor of Barcelona), sought the aid of Charlemagne in the year 777, while he was holding a meeting at Paderborn. They wished Charlemagne to proceed against Abderrahman, and they promised him that they would procure the surrender of several cities in Spain if he would appear before their gates. The offer was a tempting one, and harmonised with the king's general feeling. For Abderrahman, the Ommayad Caliph of Cordova, was the rival and enemy of the Abbaside Caliph of Bagdad, who was the friend and ally of Charlemagne, in support of whose claim to the headship of Islam a large number of Spanish Mahommedans were in arms.

It was, then, at the call of the Saracens that Charlemagne entered Spain. He was asked to intervene in support of one Islamic power against another. The question of the rival faith does not seem to have been the determining motive for this expedition. So that there is no foundation in history for the suggestion of the *chansons* and the later chronicles, that Charlemagne was moved to this enterprise by pity for the Spanish Christians groaning under Saracen oppression. In fact the situation of the Christians under Abderrahman seems to have been fairly tolerable. The historians of Spain have not hesitated to compare Charlemagne unfavourably with Abderrahman. If we consider merely the relations of Abderrahman with his own countrymen, this opinion can hardly be maintained. For it was at the request of the subjects of this very Caliph of Cordova that Charlemagne was asked to intervene in the affairs of Spain.

> "By imposing upon the inhabitants of these lands a common ecclesiastical and secular administration, by subjecting them to one allegiance and one faith, he imparted to this mighty mass of people a political unity which was never to be destroyed."

In 778 the king set out for Spain with a vast army. One part of his army followed the sea coast by way of Gerunda and Barcelona, the other, under Charlemagne, took the direct road to Pampeluna. Saragossa was to be the meeting-place. Having crossed the Pyrenees, Charlemagne first of all attacked Pampeluna, which submitted to him. Other cities followed its example. But Saragossa, the city which commanded the passage of the Ebro, refused to surrender. After a desperate sortie, Charlemagne had to retire. Disappointed with the result, he resolved to return home. Returning to Pampeluna, he levelled the walls of the city with the ground, lest it should rebel against him. He then began his march across the Pyrenees, 5,000 feet high. The highest point of the road, the "Summa Pyrenees", looked down on the wild and narrow defile of Roncesvalles, the "glyn mieri" of the Welsh translation.

In passing through this narrow defile, Charlemagne had to form his army into a long line.[15] On the highest point of the pass an ambush had been formed by the Gascons, whose operations were concealed by the dense wood growing there. When the baggage train and the rearguard came in sight, they dashed down the slopes upon them. The suddenness of the attack, and the possession of the higher ground, fully compensated for the mountaineers' inferiority in arms and discipline. According to Eginhard, the whole of the rearguard were cut to pieces. Among those who fell were many nobles of the king's court, notably, Eggihard, the seneschal of the royal court, Anselm, count of the palace, Hruoland, the prefect of the Breton march (the Roland of the *chanson*).[16] As night soon fell and the nimble invaders dispersed quickly to their homes and hiding-places, revenge was impossible. So Charlemagne returned home to Frankland with clouded brow, all his satisfaction at his successes in Spain being marred by this dishonour to his arms, and by the loss of so many friends. The date of this disaster is fixed by the epitaph of the seneschal Eggihard as the 18th of August 778.



The Coronation of Charlemagne, 800. This act symbolises the union, but distinction, of the Church and Civil Powers: Pope and Emperor.

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Such is the bare record of his history concerning this episode, which is so famous in song. By the caprice of fortune it has become the root of a whole epic literature. But *who were these Gascons*, and what was their quarrel with Charlemagne?

Certainly they were not Saracens or Mohammedans, as the *trouveres* of the later centuries supposed. They form a part of the mysterious Basque race, which has throughout the centuries of history occupied the high upland valleys on either side of the Western Pyrenees, and has given its name to Biscay in Spain, and Gascony in France. These mountaineers represent probably the oldest population of Europe of which any trace now remains. Their language is today the puzzle, the unsolved enigma, of philology. As has been said, they are not Mussulmans, and they may have "professed and called themselves Christians". And there is no need to seek any deep political combination, Christian or Mohammedan, to account for the attack on the baggage train of the Frankish king.

The men whose ancestors had been driven, perhaps two thousand years before, into their mountains by the Celts, were determined, and have been determined ever since, to keep their last asylum free from the foot of the invader. Roman and Goth had vainly tried to subdue them. And now this Frankish interloper should have a lesson that should prevent his paying too frequent visits to their mountains. Theirs was a savage love, not merely of independence, but of absolute isolation. That and the attraction of the plunder possible to them, seem quite sufficient to account for their attack on the baggage train of the king.

Other wars were undertaken by Charlemagne, against the Avars, and against the Bretons, in all of which the Franks were victorious, and the countries became the spoils of the Christian armies. Every campaign increased the prestige of the Frankish armies. The empire of the great monarch was enlarged against Slavish and Scandinavian heathendom, his troops maintained the Spanish march against all his Saracen and Christian enemies. From the Eider to Sicily, and from the Ebro to Theis, the will of Charlemagne was supreme.

It is no wonder that men who associated the ideas of imperial order and constructive civilization with the name of Rome should have recognised in the monarchy of Charlemagne the restoration of the powers of the Caesars. When, therefore, at Rome, on Christmas Eve of the year 800, he was crowned emperor of the Romans, it seemed the natural consummation of his whole career. And when, in 801, an embassy arrived with curious presents from Harun-al-Rushed, the great Caliph, who held in the East the same position as Charlemagne did in the West, men recognised in it a becoming testimony to the world-wide reputation of the Frankish emperor.

When Charlemagne ascended the throne, learning in Europe was at its lowest ebb. The old Roman civilization had passed away, partly from inward decay, partly by the attacks made on the seats of learning by uncivilized nations, and partly, and still more quickly, through the supplanting power of the new idea introduced into the world by Christianity. But after a time even Christian learning had disappeared from Western Europe, though traces of it were still left in some of the cities of Italy. With that exception learning had abandoned the continent. The darkness was profound and general. Only in distant Britain and Ireland was the lamp of learning kept burning.[17] It was Alcuin, a scion of a noble Northumbrian house, educated in the famous school of York by teachers who had sat at the feet of the Venerable Bede, who in 782 brought the light back to the continent. The plight of learning in Frankland at his coming was deplorable.

Prompted by Alcuin, Charlemagne attempted the great work of dispelling this darkness. He began at the fountain head. He established in his own court the famous school called the Palatine school, in which his own children and those of his nobles were instructed by masters of great reputation. The king invited to his court grammarians and learned men from all parts. By means of his own example he roused others to cultivate learning, both human and divine. He was himself the most eager of pupils, wanting to know everything, and everything at once.

The knowledge imparted in the school was rudimentary. The whole circle of knowledge was included in what were called the *Seven Liberal Arts*, viz., grammar, rhetoric, logic, arithmetic, music, geometry and astronomy.[18] This curriculum was an inheritance from classical antiquity. Isidore, Bishop of Seville (d. 636), published a small encyclopaedia called Etymologies, containing extracts gathered from patristic and classical authors, and this served as a thesaurus of all knowledge for centuries. In this book the arts are expressly recognised as seven. "*Discipline, liheralium artium septem sunt.*"[19]

Nor was Charlemagne's plan restricted to the palace school. He did not intend to rule a barbaric kingdom. Therefore he applied himself earnestly to bring learning to his people. Acting under such impulses, Charlemagne issued, in 787, that famous capitulary or proclamation which is the first general charter of education. It is in the form of a letter to the abbots of the different monasteries, reproving them for their lack of learning, exhorting them not to neglect the study of letters, and calling upon them to find out men who were both able and willing to learn themselves and also willing to instruct others. The soldiers of the church should be (said he) "religious in heart, learned in discourse, pure in act, eloquent in speech".

By his authority, schools were opened in connection with monasteries and cathedrals in all the provinces. Other capitularies followed, laying down more definite instructions. In 802 a proclamation was issued, calling upon fathers to send their sons to study letters.[20] There was a genuine renaissance, though its area was not very extensive.

The movement, however, rendered a double service to learning. It restored Latin to the position of a literary language, and it brought out a number of editions and copyists of such texts in Greek and Latin as had survived the wreck of ancient learning. Every student of the history of the old Latin and Greek texts knows how many of the best manuscripts date from the ninth century. This was the result of the impulse given by Charlemagne to classical studies.[21] In this respect the king of the Franks takes a foremost place among the benefactors of humanity.

Charlemagne spent the last weeks of the year 813 at Aix-la-Chapelle.[22] In January of the following year he was seized by a violent fever. Having no faith in doctors, he tried his usual remedy for fever, i.e., abstaining from food. But this only made him weaker. Soon pleurisy intervened. On the seventh day, after he had received Holy Communion, he passed quietly away, in the seventy-second year of his age, the forty-seventh year of his reign, on the fifth day before the Calends of February, at nine in the morning. The same day he was buried in the church of the Virgin there amidst universal signs of grief and sorrow.

Eginhard has preserved the inscription which was placed above his tomb:[23] —"*Sub hoc conditorio situm est corpus Karoli magni at que orthodoxi imperatoris, qui regnum Francorum nobiliter ampiiavit, et per annos XLVII feliciter rexit. Decessit septuagenarius Anno Domini DCCCXIIII, Indicitione vii. v. Kal. Febr.*"[24]

Charlemagne, we are told, had a genius for civilization.[25] Anarchy, in any shape or form, distressed him, and his impulse was to direct his efforts to check the tendency, and to produce order. Europe, in its political, social, and spiritual aspect, was in a state of disorder when Charlemagne ascended the throne, and his first thought was how to civilize Frankland and the countries around it. This was at the root of all his warlike expeditions. This, and not a mere thirst for conquest, it was that moved him to undertake them. This spirit is also made manifest in his mess to establish schools, in his taste for learning, in his predilection for the Church, and in his adoption of everything which appeared to him capable of exercising beneficial influence on society as a whole, or on man in his individual capacity.

The contribution of Charlemagne to modern civilization is different from that of many who have a great name in history. It is not so solid and manifest. He was not a great builder of cities, nor a great roadmaker, nor did he enrich the world of literature and of art.

Charlemagne was a great statesman with lofty ideals. He wished to establish a vast Christian empire on earth. He would make all nations subjects of one kingdom, and make the Church in deed what it is in word, "militant here on earth". This he undoubtedly failed to do. He could not resuscitate the old learning and civilization of Rome in a Christian state, nor graft the now Christian culture on the old stem of heathen Teutonic races. Neither could he gather in all the nations of Europe into one fold. A lifetime is far too short for the accomplishment of a scheme on so vast a scale. By his great genius he did indeed create a vast empire, but he could not give it stability. For soon after his death it gradually fell to pieces. To all intents and purposes it was buried with him in his grave at Aix-la-Chapelle. Its fall was hailed with delight by the many small nations which had been brought within its pale. Only in the Papal court, and possibly among some of the king's own descendants was there any fondness for the ideal that fired his imagination and disturbed his dreams—the whole continent united politically under one emperor, and spiritually under one bishop. The grand purpose that dominated his mind was not fulfilled, and it was better for Europe that it was not.[26] Nevertheless, the mind that could conceive such a noble thought at that period in history, and environed by the sordid ideas that then prevailed both in the church and in the world at large, reveals a man whom the succeeding centuries have rightly acclaimed as truly great. He failed to realize his ideal because it was, and is, too grand for this world.[27] But in any case, he had the sweet consciousness of knowing—

"How far high failure overleaps the bound of low successes."[28]

The ideal he entertained embraced more than one nationality. It took in all men. The catholicity of Charlemagne's character is one of its most striking features. He was a Frank only in dress.[29] What Turpin's romance says of Roland, according to the Welsh version, is certainly true of Charlemagne, "*Karedic gantaw pob dyn. Ual pei brawt idaw uei bob cristawn.*"[30] ("He entertained kindly feelings towards every man. As a brother, he watched over every Christian.")

Charlemagne's greatness was in the nobility of his aim, and in the energy and wisdom and tact with which he carried it out during his life. Notwithstanding the general wreck of his empire, in greatness of character, in many-sided activity, and in magic influence of a name potent for good among succeeding generations, Charlemagne stands second to none of the great ones of the world.

"The expedition into Spain is the theme of many a stirring song sung by the minstrels of old in all the countries of Europe. What is the true history of this episode? Why did Charlemagne enter Spain?"

Charlemagne imposed upon himself the duty of civilising and unifying the western half of Europe, particularly those of the Germanic race, while also promoting and protecting the Faith in his lands: grace building on nature.

1. Freeman, p. 122
2. Vita, cap. iii.
3. Guizot, p. 163.
4. Vita, cap. v.
5. Vita, cap. vii
6. Ananales, A.D. 772
7. Ibid, A.D. 773
8. Ibid, A.D. 777
9. Annales, A.D. 784
10. Davis, p. 93.
11. Vita, cap. vi.
12. Ibid, cap. xviii
13. Davis, p. 82
14. Vide Welsh Text, p.2.
15. Vita, cap. ix.
16. Vita, cap. ix.
17. Mosheim's Eccl. Hist., p. 266
18. West, p.5. Vide Welsh Text, pp. 104, 105.
19. West, p. 23
20. West, p. 108.
21. Hodgkin's Charles the Great, p. 235.
22. Vita, caps. xxx, xxxi
23. Vita, cap. xxxi.
24. Note that in this inscription Charlemagne is called "the great and orthodox emperor", and not "Charles the great". It was some time after this that the "Magnus" became linked to the "Karolus".
25. Guizot, p. 68.
26. Editor: As it is presented, this claim is merely an assertion, and requires proof. Nevertheless, it is an interesting topic for conversation.
27. Editor: Once again, we are presented with another claim that requires some proof. Whilst our fallen world will always retain the wounds of original sin, by Grace, the world might be elevated to it's earthly potential as that foretaste of the perfect life to come.
28. "Marsyas" in The Epic of Hades, by Sir Lewis Morris.
29. Vita, cap. xxiii.
30. Welsh Text, p. 100.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

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Culture as Propaganda

The Inauguration of Organised Political Warfare

Frank Wright

Our contemporary contribution to this issue comes from Frank Wright, a Catholic, an Englishman, and a writer. He is a regular contributer to LifeSiteNews *and is known for his dismantling of our modern liberal system which is the antithesis of the Catholic ideal. In this article, Mr Wright pinpoints how most of of the cultural products of the liberal age are brought to us through the same delivery mechanisms as those discovered and used during WWII.*

The second great violent revolution of the 20th century is known as World War Two.

It has become a totem charged with manufactured belief which has, until now, completely refashioned our sense of history, morality, politics and purpose.

This belief did not emerge from the ashes of Europe. It was made, intentionally, as liberal power turned to the mobilisation of every aspect of culture to make belief—in itself.

This is the story of the sale of the 20th Century, a transaction in which we exchanged everything for nothing.

Allied poster during WWII. Notice the union of the banners of the United Kingdom, the United States and the USSR.

How was this done?

In this extract from the seventh chapter of my book, *"A Brief History of Liberal Democracy"*, I examine how the methods developed in both world wars powered the *total mobilisation of culture in the service of the liberal system.*

Its goal was to promote social revolution at home and abroad—to secure a global empire.

The CIA was created in 1947. One year later its power was mobilized in a new strategy published by George Kennan. Called "Organized Political Warfare", this was a blueprint for the use of every mode of cultural production to be mustered in the promotion and defense of liberal democracy.

What is the Liberal System?

The liberal system is an *economic system* whose politics are, like everything else it makes, an advertisement for a product. The successful sale of this product results in power, and the power this system sought was total.

That product is sold with impossible promises. It sells a life without limits: limitless growth in the economy, limitless human potential, the power to redefine yourself by what you buy—and what you buy into.

It tells you that the advertisement can become your reality, if you believe in it. This is the new and improved *liberal utopia*—in theory a worldly paradise of pure glamour, but which reduces to death on credit in practice.

It has *liberated us from meaning*, and has impoverished every aspect of life. This international nowhere is the utopian product for which our entire civilisation has been exchanged.

How was this demand for the impossible normalised? After the second world war, as after the first, a new world was made possible. The liberal alliance with Bolshevism was over, its common enemy defeated in Germany.

The fact that the liberal West allied with Satanic Bolshevism—the most murderous ideology of the past hundred years—is officially disremembered.

Hollywood has memorialised World War Two into a cult whose power competes with that of Christ to explain the nature of mankind and his condition.

Our history, our sense of ourselves, of what is right and what is wrong, our beliefs about the nature of mankind and our purpose on this earth— these are the myths of the century of sales which is now closing down. Why did this happen?

The Postwar Predicament

The United States, the leader of this economic system with global ambitions, had with the UK armed the Soviet Union so successfully it had fostered a counterforce which would be impossible to overcome conventionally in Europe.

With the *transmission of Manhattan Project nuclear secrets to the Soviets* by the Rosenbergs beginning in 1942, the technological advantage of the atomic bomb was lost. *A second unconventional method was developed*—before the Soviets' first nuclear test in 1949.

One year after the creation of the CIA, George Kennan produced his 1948 paper. It was called "On the Inauguration of Organised Political Warfare".

The fact that our mass culture is the product of the sponsorship of global social revolution begun by the CIA is startling enough.

That the CIA itself is partly the *product of revolutionaries* fighting for Communism in the Spanish Civil War may help to explain why.

As this second source also claims, the "CIA was founded by communists who fought in the Spanish Civil War".

Pictured is the New York Jewish communist Milton Wolff, the last commander of the Lincoln Battalion of XV International Brigade. He worked for the CIA's precursor, the OSS—and recruited many of his fellow communists into British and American intelligence.

These absence of these startling facts

> "Our history, our sense of ourselves, of what is right and what is wrong, our beliefs about the nature of mankind and our purpose on this earth—these are the myths of the century of sales which is now closing down."

from popular memory help to explain why we believe what we do. They help us to understand how the technique of the manufacture of belief has been refined by warfare, through the assimilation of subversive tactics developed in them.

Organised Political Warfare

What was "Organised Political Warfare"?

It was the *total mobilisation of all forms of cultural production* in the service of the Liberal system. Its ambitions to dominate the world would see culture at home and abroad sponsored by government agencies to propagandise its present and future subjects, making the belief that this was the perfect and final system in human affairs.

This was a serious *upgrade to the industry of public relations*, or propaganda, which had birthed the liberal system of the management of millions through the manufacture of belief following the First World War.

It has produced the system we inhabit today. Refined by technological innovations and in its technique, the global reach of cultural production has been revealed by the actions of *USAID*.

The promotion of *social revolution in the West* and beyond has been partially exposed by this scandal, as yesterday's global empire becomes today's corruption. Yet this did not begin with the previous US government, and nor is it the property of the left.

Organised political warfare is the use of cultural production to annihilate everything the liberal global system is not—by demor-

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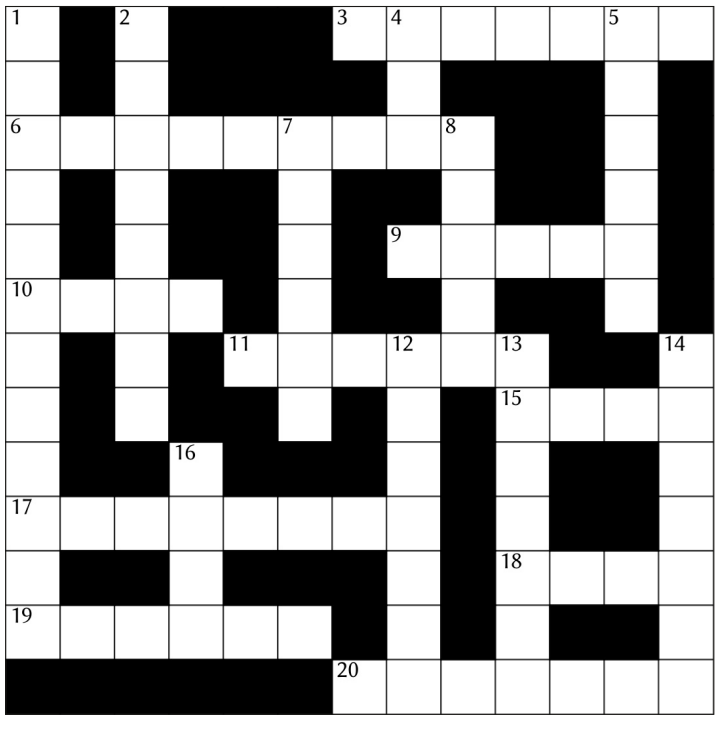
PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

CROSSWORD



Across

3) The name to those fielded in battle who fought hand-to-hand unmounted (7)
6) A term for describing a religious who has has made their final vows (9)
9) Greek companion of Saint Paul (5)
10) The number of angelic choirs (4)
11) Body of water adjacent to the Mediteranean Sea (3-3)
15) It would have smelled as sweet if it were given another name (4)
17) That which describes the type of connection between two things (8)
18) That word which concludes a prayer, used to re-affirm the words of the prayer (4)
19) That arch-typical arch-heretic (6)
20) An insult describing someone as faint-hearted (7)

Down

1) That order which doesn't replace the natural but elevates and perfects it (12)
2) Stomping ground of Savonarola and Dante (8)
4) The number of gods that exist in reality (3)
5) That word from Latin/French meaning stop (6)
7) To filter out, or to act as a barrier (6)
8) To power, to push, to move forward (5)
12) Franco was of the _____ nation (7)
13) The language of the commonfolk of first century Palestine (7)
14) Where cedar trees grow (7)
16) That sinful type of judgement which judges as sinful what is hidden (4)

CALTROP SWEEPER

	4	3	2	1		0	1		3		1	0
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3		5			4		3	2	4	5		
3		3	4				6		3			3
		2			5				3	2	3	2
3			3		4		5	4	2		2	
	2			3	3			4		1	2	
2			3		3					2	3	3
2		3	4		3	3			2	1		
	3				2			4		3	3	2
	3	3		2	1	2					1	
2		4	4		1	1		6		4		0
1							2			2		0

Culture as Propaganda Cont.

> "The subtraction of real meaning from life promotes a hunger we struggle to explain, and which is satisfied in this system by signals of virtue."

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alisation, assimilation and promises of liberation.

The solution to the problem of securing and managing human life in a global market is to dissolve everything into itself. Cultural production is coordinated to replace difference with sameness, to weave us all into the rainbow flag of progress. This is the reason our reality is now a ruin, haunted by the dreams of the machine.

Rule by Algorithm

The first phase of the creation of an algorithm of governance through mass communication had grown out of attempts to persuade Americans to enter the Great War in 1917.

Kennan's secret document was a paradigm shift. It would see this method of the making of belief magnified—from the selling of products and political policies—to the promotion of the liberal ideology through every avenue of cultural life.

Today, we can see how *computing technology* is powering another paradigm of the management of mass society. Yet the advent of man management by mass machinery is not a recent development.

It is an update—the refinement of a technique over a century old. *That technique is cultural production.*

The Sale of the Century

Liberal cultural production sells a manufactured present, past and future as a reality without rational alternatives.

In fact, these are all products—of the system we inhabit. The century of sales sells us its myths not to liberate or emancipate us, but to make us believe its promises are true, and the reality it produces is false.

If we submit to this artificial paradise then all is well. If we doubt it, we risk ostracism or worse. It presents its products as *secular mysteries*, as totems of belief so powerful as to *counter the explanatory power* of the message of Christ.

Why is this important? Even if you do not believe that *Christianity is true*, it remains true that it is the foundation of European civilisation. Its power to explain life, what the purpose of it is, and how it should be lived, is a threat to a system which can only succeed by eliminating the competition.

The liberal mythos promises freedom and so prefers the carrot to the stick. As David Colon pointed out in "Propaganda—The Manipulation of the Masses in the Modern World", *the liberal system replaces the baton with the persuasion of cultural propaganda.*

The Power of Cultural Production

Liberal cultural production assimilates and neutralises Christianity along with any other form of explanation. It subverts everything to its own purpose.

This is the reason the *modern Church suppresses Catholic tradition* and promotes progressive social revolution. Its values are the values of Google, of NATO, of the World Economic Forum and the European Union.

It is both victim and vehicle of cultural production, showing a process by which the uniforms change, but the uniformity of messaging does not.

No institution today serves the statement made in its name. The value pluralists are plural only in appearance, and they *all promote the same secular cult.*

These are the *values of the economic system*, whose *open borders* are required to *depress wages* and living conditions, whose *wars are required* to absorb new markets and materials, and which sees *humanity as a problem* to be managed into distraction, offering the virtuous label of tolerance to those hungry for approval and meaning.

Tolerance: Manufacturing Hunger

The subtraction of real meaning from life promotes a hunger we struggle to explain, and which is satisfied in this system by signals of virtue.

These *virtues are vices* in reality, but signalling them brings virtual and real rewards. They are signs of loyalty or submission to the system, akin to a dog begging for treats by making puppy eyes.

The central virtue of the liberal culture is to be "value plural", as it was in its early postwar form.

The greatest prophet of 20th Century liberalism said this. *Isaiah Berlin*, who remains a very interesting thinker regardless, was *promoted by the CIA* to popularise the *belief that the liberal system was supreme* because it tolerated all other systems.

It is forgotten that the system we have now is not the one that Berlin championed, but the *despotism of elite rule he condemned.* This myth has served its purpose because it is now widely believed without demonstration.

Domination by Warfare

Cultural production has seen to that, just as it has distorted the Second World War in the image of Hollywood. *The war was not won by Tom Hanks*, as many seem to believe, but by the Soviets—using British and American arms and cash.

Of the estimated $160 billion the US loaned to Stalin in WWII, less than a billion was paid back.

The British had to pay every penny, and only did so in 2006. The debt they owed the United States to fight both wars would effectively enslave them in the liberal system which replaced their Empire.

To this day Britain's defaulted World War One debt owed to the United States remains unpaid, and could amount—with interest—to trillions of dollars.

As we see, *the liberal system is a war system.* Its emergence, its military and financial dominance and the cultural production which secured it were all downstream of real wars which became conceptual.

Not only *mythologised*, the wars produced *techniques* which made possible a *permanent state of war on and off the battlefield,* in the service of a dream of a global empire.

Liberal Supremacy

The "value pluralism" of Isaiah Berlin is the root of liberal evil. It permits the condition of *liberal chauvinism*, which is why our elites act as if they and only they are correct.

This is because they believe they are right because only they have the right beliefs. The power of the belief in liberal supremacy permits the persecution of doubt and disagreement over its claims to being the supreme ideology—a claim it also made with *Fukuyama's* proclamation of the "End of History".[1]

In this fantasy narrative, the Second World War was fought for tolerance and the liberal global enlightenment, which calls the light of the civilisation it seeks to replace a darkness and a curse.

Of course, this victory was produced in partnership with the *most murderous ideology of the 20th century*, and then partitioned the European order between Soviet dictatorship and the despotism of liberal elite rule.

It *created mysteries* such as modern "art" to promote the belief that nothing meant a profound and inexplicable something.

It was not only *Pollock* but *Rothko*, the abstract expressionists and the Museum of Modern Art itself which were funded and *promoted by the CIA* as an advertisement for the dynamic power of liberal "individualism". Of course, when this is examined—as with the paintings themselves—there is nothing there but money and babble.

Postwar culture was infused with a pre-postmodern *demoralisation*, creating a performative ethic of the new meaningless out of the mythos of the Second World War.

To understand the pioneers of cultural production is to understand why we now have nothing where there used to be something.

I Believe because It Is Absurd

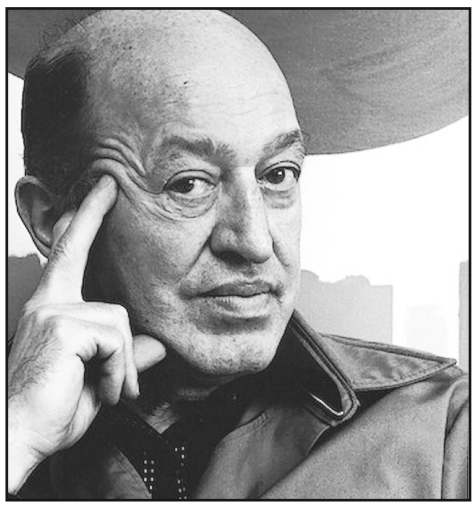
Our mass culture is a *replacement culture.* It is the expression of the world as a marketplace of counterfeits, with everything in it on offer at a price.

Time, money, meaning—life—these are all things merely to spend. The system produces failure, it fails better than ever. How did we get here?

Global consumer culture has consumed us in a universal sense of the absurd. This is no accident, and another example of *cultural production* shows precisely how actual warfare has promoted the technique of cul-

Continued on Page 10

Culture as Propaganda Cont.



Clement Greenberg, who said taste was objective and could be refined—by listening to people like Clement Greenberg.

Continued from Page 9

tural production.

Julius Pereszlenyi was an Austro-Hungarian Jew who fled to Britain following the 1938 Anschluss. He initially worked to "deliver counterpropaganda in BBC broadcasts to Nazi Germany".

He changed his name to *Martin Esslin*, and later produced a theory of cultural production whose explanatory power remains startling today.

In his 1961 book The Theatre of the Absurd, Esslin defined the school of absurdism as "*the inevitable devaluation of ideals, purity, and purpose*".

He was talking about plays produced in theatres. His description matches the obscene spectacle of the liberal system.

The condition of the absurd is understood by the Godless to be that of our lives: we are born to die, and there is nothing but ourselves between the twinned oblivions which bookend our existence.

This is the cultural production of the meaninglessness of life. In such a predicament there is no higher purpose than the seeking of bargains and the satisfaction of desire.

It is life as a void to be filled, a mere interval amidst two others.

Art Minus Beauty

In the United States, *Clement Greenberg* popularised the abstract expressionists. His example of "thought leadership" is seen in the widespread rejection of the idea of beauty and its replacement by sophisticated "taste".

Such people who believe this can not only prefer the naked Emperor, but openly celebrate his exhibitionism as a signal of their own superiority.

Greenberg was also sponsored by the CIA[2]. To consider his legacy, ask why the assertion that *beauty is an objective truth* provokes howls of outrage today.

Forever World War Two

In these and other ways the Second World War occasioned a great *countercultural force* in the service of power, to *replace morality and meaning* with a new mythos. News, entertainment, art, theatre, corporate messaging, health advice, education—these and all other mediums of mass communication transmit *unbelief in everything other than the liberal system* which sponsors them.

This is the sale of the 20th Century—the counter civilisational project to level down the nations in the name of universal uplift, and to replace the purpose of their lives and their belief in it with a faith that could be as common to all as processed chicken.

It promotes transcendence through transvaluation. It is trans-civilisation, trans-sane and urges the transition of humanity into a posthuman future.

The *intentional destruction of norms* in morality and in meaning is a necessary phase in the replacement of what was with what some believe should be.

It has given us a *counterfeit church*, a contrived and distorted *history*, a defence industry devoted to *permanent war*, and a system of *politics* in which there is no escape from paying taxes to fund the destruction of civilisation.

This method reveals the fact that the *supermarket model of human liberty* restricts choice to the available product line. If you do not like the fact you can only vote for blue, red, yellow or green Liberals then of course there must be something wrong with you.

The management of mass society by means of cultural production is the *original algorithm of Western liberal government.* It mirrored the Soviet attempt through Gosplan to centrally manage the Soviet economy. Conversely, the liberal global model would attempt to assimilate nations into its market system, with the beckoning figure of cultural production accompanied by the threat of force.

With the *advent of artificial intelligence* comes the alluring prospect of a machine to guide the machinery of management. There is hope in some faction of the elites that the complexity of our inventions can overcome the human limitations of management which gamed the Soviet economy into stalemate and extinction.

Invisible Dominance

What is the power of cultural production—the purpose of organised political warfare?

It is the reason Western populations are so *propaganda naive.* When we think of political propaganda we imagine iconic images of Stalin, Mao, or Kim Jong-Il and the slogans of Rodchenko.

The propaganda which made our beliefs is invisible because it is everything.

Our politics, mass culture, education, our entertainment, corporate messaging, our news, the people who shape our views and the agents who police them, our literature, poetry and even our modern ideas of religion are all messages from their sponsors.

The liberal system is *an illusion of freedom presented as the pinnacle of liberation.* It is an *economic war model* which seeks to destroy everything that it is not—and it does this through the two expressions of human power—force and persuasion.

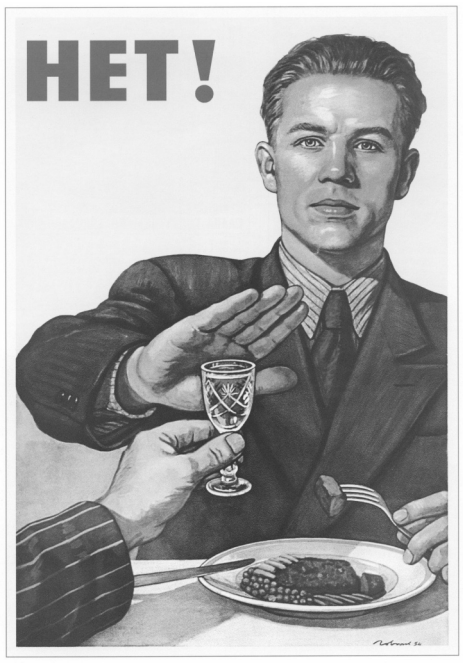
Mental Health as Cultural Warfare

It is important to remember that cultural production seeks to make the imagination of any other way of living impossible. One purpose of organised political warfare is to code negatively any meaningful dissent.

The concept of "*conflict resolution*" was developed to combat an expected wave of postwar "antisemitism" which never materialised. This model categorised inflexible critics of the liberal system as mentally disordered—requiring re-education through therapy. The system would give you all the help you did not need to cure you of the wrong sort of freedom of belief.

A *therapeutic culture industry* has grown out of this method of containment through *condescending neutralisation.* The liberal model tells its subject populations that the *only tribe is the global tribe.*

"Conversely, the liberal global model would attempt to assimilate nations into its market system, with the beckoning figure of cultural production accompanied by the threat of force."



A Soviet Poster promoting temperance. When was the last time our liberal culture told you to "say no"?

The mass culture of liberal democracy is a sickness promoted as medicine. It is palliative care for life redefined as a terminal disease.

This grandest of narratives, which is now producing an epidemic of incredulity, has delivered us into a political and personal permanent state of emergency for which there is no remedy but to criminalise the sane.

The victory of organised political warfare was to recreate the West in the image of an image—an artwork of artifice, a picture perfect snapshot of a place that never really existed.

It was the most ambitious attempt in history to use technology and mass communication to reinvent mankind, his sense of the past, present and future, to sell him yet another god that failed.

More of Frank Wright can be found at https://www.frankwrighter.com/.

1. Fukuyama has admitted the liberal system has failed.
2. Frances Stonor Saunders wrote extensively on how the cultural cold war began—and never really ended, documenting the CIA and NED sponsorship of cultural production.

A Woman's Duties as Wife

The Duty of Obedience and Companionship

Fr Bernard O' Reilly

Woman's Duties as Wife

The first duty of the wife is to study to be in every way she can the companion, the help, and the friend of her husband. Indeed on her capacity to be all this, and her earnest fulfillment of this threefold function depends all the happiness of both their lives, as well as the well-being of the whole family. Hence the obligation which is incumbent on parents providing for the establishment of their children, to see to it, so far as is possible, that the person chosen to be a wife in the new home should be a true companion for their son, a true helpmate in all his toil, and a faithful friend through all the changes of fortune.

She ought to be a Companion to her Husband

One half of the unhappiness of married life comes from the fact that the wife is either unfitted or unwilling to be a true companion to her husband. This companionship requires that she should be suited by her qualities of mind and heart and temper to enter into her husband's thoughts and tastes and amusements, so as to make him find in her company and conversation a perfect contentment and delight.

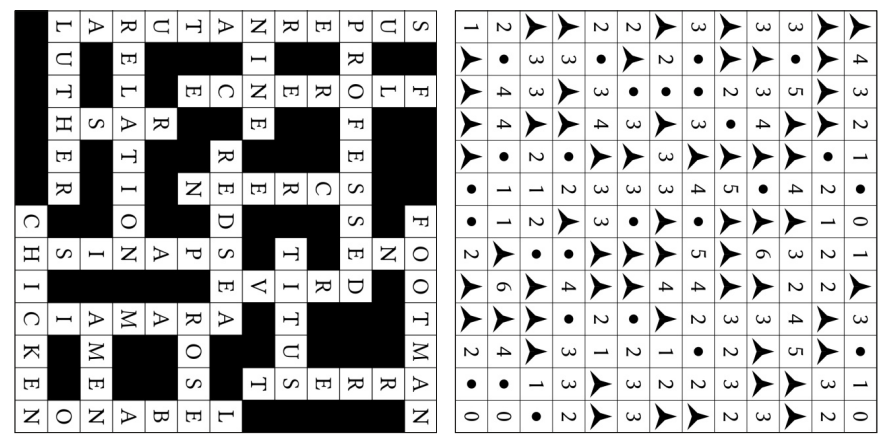
Persons who are perfectly companionable never weary of each other, indeed, they are never perfectly happy while away from each other; they enter into each other's thoughts, reflect (and increase by the reflection) the light in each other's mind; cultivate the same tastes, pursue the same ideals, and complete each other in the interchange of original or acquired knowledge.

But there is more than that in the companionship of the true wife. She studies to make herself agreeable, delightful, and even indispensable to him who is her choice among all men. If true love be in her heart, it will suggest to her, day by day, a thousand new devices for charming the leisure of her husband.

Woman has been endowed by the Creator with a marvelous fertility of resource in this respect: it is an unlimited power, productive of infinite good when used for a holy purpose and within her own kingdom; but productive of infinite evil when employed in opposition to the design of the Giver, or allowed to lie idle when it should be used to promote the sacred ends of domestic felicity.

Mirror of True Womanhood was published in 1883.

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS



The Value of Work

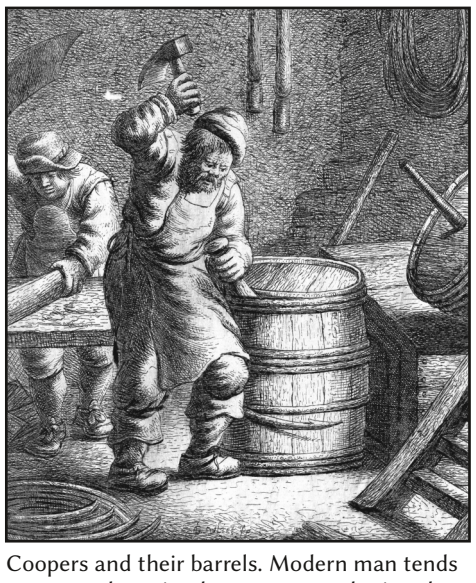
That Duty of Each Man

Fr Cuthbert OSFC

To the majority of men there is hardly a greater evil in life than having nothing definite to do, no particular business or profession. A definite occupation is in itself a moral discipline. To have to be up and doing at a certain time, to have to think of something other than oneself or one's idle fancies, is to most men little less than spiritual salvation. It matters not much what the work is, so that it is honest; its value lies not so much in its immediate usefulness or inherent quality as in its moral effect on the worker himself. Even the most menial work may thus have a high moral value. But work and a definite occupation of some kind are essential to a healthy moral life.

This truth has been recognised by almost all moral reformers. In the monastic orders it plays a prominent part in daily life. The monastic rules all regard idleness as a capital sin, the source of temptations. When not engaged in prayer, the monk had allotted to him work of another kind, either manual or mental, and as in many other ways so in the history of labour the monk plays no ignoble part. There have been of course idle monks: monastic orders are not made up of angels. But the idle monk has ever been one who has fallen away from the monastic ideal and lost the monastic spirit; and in the reform of orders we find the obligation of being constantly and usefully employed, generally emphasised.

Nor are the monastic orders alone in their insistence on the duty of working: ethical reformers of all sorts have taken much the same line. The Brook Farm community in America, and Tolstoi in Russia, are instances in modern times. And it is to be noticed that the monastic orders have this in common with the socialistic enthusiasts, that they all impose manual labour. Intellectual effort might be encouraged and fostered amongst the monks, but side by side with study went some form of manual work, at least in the more primitive communities. Later on, as the conditions of society became more complex, and the demands upon the activity of the monks became more varied, manual labour largely gave way to missionary and social work. Nevertheless, even then manual labour was held in honour and kept its place as a primary element in the monastic discipline, having its place in the life of the community even though in individual cases it might give place to other demands. But a difference in the attitude of the monk towards labour from that of the socialistic enthusiast must here be noted, as it marks off the Catholic spirit from the secularist. Prayer with the monks was considered the highest occupation, and the duty of having external occupations was contingent upon certain temporal conditions. In exceptional cases indeed a monk might be dispensed from ordinary external work, and be allowed to give himself entirely to prayer and contemplation. The moral value of manual labour and external activities was taken to be not absolute, but relative. It was considered necessary partly as a preventive of idleness between the hours of prayer, partly as an ordinary means of securing a healthy, physical and mental life, and partly it entered into the discipline of monastic poverty. In a word, external occupation was considered to be a moral discipline which was undoubtedly necessary for the ordinary individual, but not an absolute law of the moral life; some people might indeed perfect their souls without it. The idea of making any form of external occupation absolutely obligatory without exception would have been considered by the monastic legislators as an infringement of that liberty of soul which belongs to man in his relation with God. And herein lies one of the essential differences between the Catholic idea and the secularist. Nevertheless, for ordinary mortals some external occupation was considered by the monks necessary to a sound moral life.



Coopers and their barrels. Modern man tends to see work as simply a means to obtain token wealth; that is, money, to then spend on arranging his affairs. Whilst this certainly may be true, it is an incomplete perspective. For it is not the token wealth received in payment that the value of work ought to be measured, but rather it is how the performance of the work served man's fellow man.

Now the monastic discipline gives us the key to the right Catholic attitude in regard to this question. For the monastic life in its first elements is but a more intense form of the Christian life. Though we may not say with the secularist that *external* occupation is an absolute law of social ethics, yet we are to hold that an idle life—a life devoid of social usefulness, material or spiritual—is always wrong, a crime against the social body, as well as against one's own soul. And the social injustice of an idle life does not arise merely when a man becomes a burden on the public rates or on private charity. He may indeed have sufficient inheritance to support him in idleness, and yet the injustice against the social body will remain. For every man, be he rich or poor, is obliged by the natural law of human society to contribute his part towards the common good. An idle millionaire therefore sins against social justice equally with the idle beggar, and perhaps more so, since his wealth and education gives him larger opportunities for serving society. It is in truth in the essential solidarity of the human race that the social injustice of the idle life begins. No man belongs entirely to himself: society has always an unquestionable claim upon him. In the widespread awakening of the popular mind to this truth lies in fact much of the strength of the socialist propaganda. The socialists, in insisting upon the solidarity of society, have become to an increasing number of men the exponents of a deep moral truth. It is a truth to which Catholicism has borne evidence throughout the long ages of its history; but the socialists, by preaching this doctrine with a loud voice and perpetual insistence, have made themselves in popular estimation its proper exponents. In opposing the socialist propaganda, Catholics have perhaps failed to recognise sufficiently this Catholic truth behind the vagaries and errors of socialist teaching, and thereby have seemed to the populace to ignore it. Where the socialist goes astray in the application of this truth is that he seeks to realize it in practices by legal coercion to the exclusion of the claims of individual conscience; he inordinately deprives the individual of a share in the moral government of his own life, and makes him a mere creature of the State or community. Catholicism, on the other hand, seeks to realize the moral solidarity of the race by making the individual the custodian of the common good, and making him primarily answerable to God, and only in a secondary degree to the State. Thus the Church reserves inviolate the proper liberty of Human life. The Socialist would force a man to labour by legal penalties; Catholicism makes his responsibility depend rather upon his own innate sense of social justice.[1] Not that the Church would altogether disapprove of legal pressure being brought to bear upon the idle to force them to work; only that normally her aim is as far as possible to make a man's conscience, rather than legal coercion, the guide and informant of his moral life; whereas the tendency of socialism is to supplant conscience by external law.

Hence in regard to work, the Church does not insist less upon every man's duty to work, because she maintains that this duty belongs to the higher domain of conscience which does not come altogether within the jurisdiction of the State, or because she holds to the inherent right of every individual, subject to certain moral considerations, to choose his own vocation or action. She holds that there is a universal obligation upon all men to lead an honest, useful life; and this obligation she traces to a twofold source: the duty every individual owes directly to God, to exercise his God-given powers, and the duty we all owe to society to contribute to its welfare.

According to the Catholic mind, therefore, the obligation to work would exist though society did not exist: it is inherent in the individual himself, a duty one owes to God, the Author of life; and this duty, as it is prior to the duty one owes to society, so also it governs our relation to society and the demands society may lawfully make upon us. Catholicism can never admit the right of society to determine altogether the scope of a man's work. Self-development is but another aspect of the law of self-preservation, and constitutes one of the primary duties we owe to God;

"Though we may not say with the secularist that *external* occupation is an absolute law of social ethics, yet we are to hold that an idle life—a life devoid of social usefulness, material or spiritual—is always wrong, a crime against the social body, as well as against one's own soul."

and, except in certain contingencies where the duty of self-sacrifice supervenes, the preservation and development of one's own life is an inherent right of the individual which the State may not infringe. But the development of a man's life is governed by a certain internal necessity which no external authority can altogether control or direct. There are lines of thought and action along which the individual must necessarily work, if he is to get the best out of his life; nor are any two individuals ever on exactly the same lines. Any external coercion therefore which takes a man off his own proper lines is an infringement of personal liberty, which only exceptional circumstances or the very existence of society, can justify. There are indeed cases in which the very highest self-development is attained by self-sacrifice, and when the supreme purpose of life is encompassed in death. Nor is there any true development which does not demand self-sacrifice of some sort. In self-sacrifice we may—and often do— attain to the ultimate expression of our moral and spiritual character, and so reach our highest human development. Nevertheless this development ordinarily runs upon the lines of our daily occupations, and if it is to run healthily and with a natural fullness, the individual must have a wide discretion in the choice of his own work and in its execution. And this the Catholic spirit demands.

At the same time however there are always the just claims of society to be

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NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome, dear Reader, to the fifth issue of *The Plough.*

We have now passed through the threshold of the Feast of the Purification, and into the battlefield of Lent. May it be fruitful for you.

As much as we might not like to admit, our liberal world today has a deep hold of our thinking. One way this can be seen is by our attitude towards power and authority.

Today, as Catholics, we are afraid to use legitimate means to assert Christ's rights as King of all creation. Though we might profess Christ and the rights of His Church openly, by our shirking of power, we tacitly concede that, rather than offend God, it is liberalism that we dare not offend.

Take for example that co-worker. We are quite happy to convince him to use better language by arguments and persuasion, because arguments and persuasion ultimately don't infringe upon the dogmas of the liberal world—that coercion is evil. But the enacting of blasphemy laws—the solution to the problem on a social level—we cannot bear, as it cuts deep into our liberal sentiments.

In days gone by, our European ancestors carried no such burden to appease liberalism. Instead, they built cathedrals, burnt the talmud, and repelled foreigners who would upset our precious Christian order.

Power is the raw capability, strength, or ability to compel, whereas authority is the moral, legal, and rightful claim to command, derived from divine law or the natural law for the common good. Power without authority is tyranny, while authority without power is doomed to yield to tyranny.

Take the case of Spain: if those Spanish generals did not take it upon themselves to wield power for good, then it would have been Christ's enemies who had consolidated their control of the state.

Power is a reality. If we are in a position of authority, power is not something that we have a right to abstain from. As men, it is our job to learn how to use our authority for the common good. Our training from infantcy has taught us that power is evil. Wrong. Power without authority is evil. Power with authority is good and is an essential part of God's plan for the temporal order and for the salvation of souls.

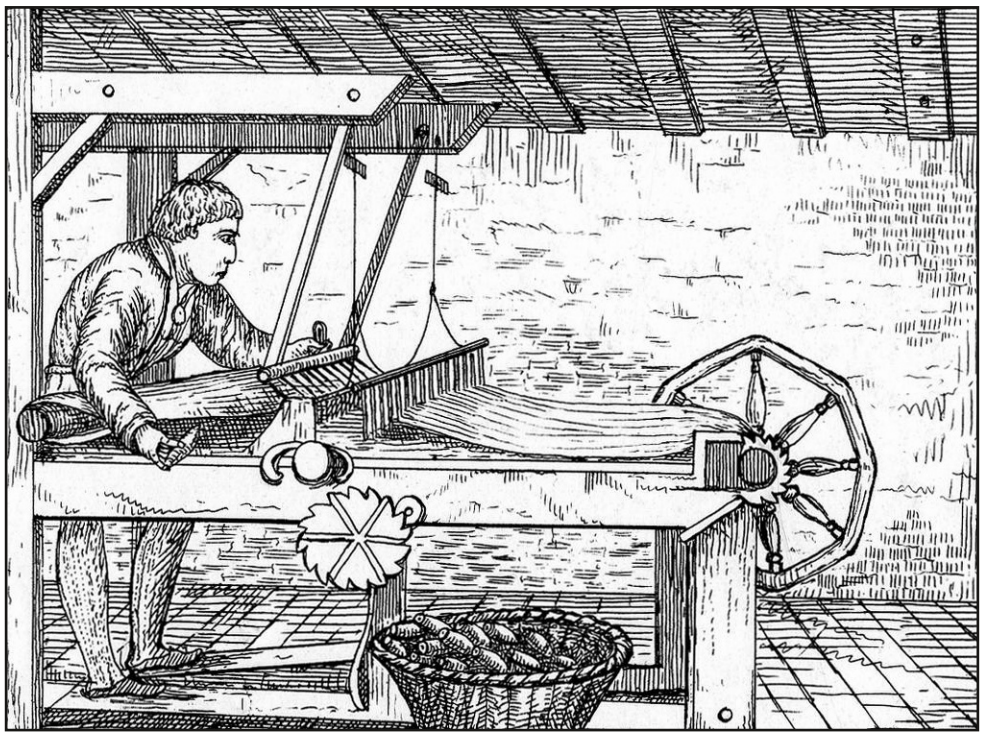
Lord Acton in 1887 once said: "Power tends to corrupt and absolute power corrupts absolutely." This is a liberal maxim, and not a Catholic maxim. Let us reject it proudly. Perhaps the Catholic version might read: "It is the duty of men to wield themselves for the good of Christ's Kingdom on earth, for their own and for their fellow's salvation."

May the examples of Charlemagne and Francisco Franco help cure us of our liberal malaise. May we be encouraged to redouble our efforts as men to learn to use our authority well.

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you,

Editor of *The Plough.*

The Value of Work Cont.



A weaver at his loom. It is not that the weaver gets paid (token wealth) that is the value of this scene, but rather that thread has now become cloth (real wealth), for the benefit of some other.

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considered, and these claims in no small measure condition a man's proper development. No man has a right to work simply and solely for his own pleasure without reference to the public good. If a man has to bear the burden of his own life, he has also to bear some share of the burden of the social organism to which he belongs; and so whilst exercising his liberty for the realization of his own powers he must so order his life as to benefit his fellow-men. To do otherwise would be a virtual denial of that human kinship which is implied in the evangelical precept of neighbourly love. "Bear ye one another's burdens" is a law of life as revealed by Christ. We belong not wholly to ourselves, but in part to our fellow-men, and therefore we have to work so as to benefit them as well as ourselves. That is the law in few words. Exactly where the benefit to one's neighbour comes in, is sometimes a fine matter of judgement which must be left to the individual himself to decide. Society does not always recognize its own good, and not infrequently fails to see the future benefit which is plain to the active individual. The common lot of this world's benefactors is to work on in spite of the world's mockery and opposition. For the majority of men indeed it is well that they take up some work or occupation with a recognized social value attached to it; since the majority of men are not gifted with an insight and judgement superior to that of their fellows. But there are always others whose individual judgement corrects that of the majority and eventually puts it to shame. Their lives are of the greatest social value, yet are not socially recognized as such. Hence as I say the usefulness of a man's life is often a fine matter for his own judgement. Here all that we would point out is the general moral principle underlying the Christian consciousness that every man's work must have a reference to the public good as well as to his own self-development. It may be the purely spiritual influence of the Carthusian monk, or the benefit conferred by the statesman or by the ordinary citizen. But in some way or other, every man must take his share of the common burden. The drone, even though he have bonds and shares to support him; the dilettante, who fills up his life with hobbies of no possible benefit to the community—both are equally offenders against the social body, and properly outlaws from society.

But a question which is forced upon us by certain modern enthusiasts is: How far is a man bound to support himself by his own labour? Is there in fact any obligation at all upon a man to earn his own bread? Tolstoi and the majority of ethical reformers of the secularist school make it a point in their programme that every man shall support himself in the sweat of his brow; it is a deduction from their denial of the right of private property. Catholicism, however, with its wider conception of human society, holds this principle in reprobation as an infringement of that right of personal liberty which is at the basis of Christian social ethics. Everyone must indeed lead a useful, honest life, so as to be of benefit to society; and in this sense, if you will, everyone must earn his bread. But it would destroy the liberty of human society and prevent the highest human development, were everyone forced to work for his bread in the narrower sense of the term. The best human work is not to be appreciated in coin, and often fails to bring the worker even a sufficiency of bread. Moreover, the principle of inheritance is inherent in the Catholic conception of society as the natural and historical extension of the individual.

Taken, therefore, as an absolute principle, no Catholic can consistently maintain that every man is morally bound to earn his own bread in the sense in which a lawyer or a shop-keeper is said to earn his living. At the same time there is abundant Catholic authority in favour of this principle taken not absolutely, but relatively to particular persons and vocations.

Undoubtedly for the majority of men the necessity of having to work in order to live is a blessing not easily over-rated. Most men, unless their bread depends upon the performance of a certain amount of work, would not work at all. There is in the multitude an ingrained tendency to idleness which nothing but the danger of starvation can effectually hold in check. Moreover, even in the energetic there is often an inability to employ one's energies usefully, unless their path is marked out for them by some wage-earning employment. Hence, having regard for the moral conditions in which most men find themselves, who will say that it would not be well for society if a large number of those born to luxury found themselves compelled by loss of means to work for their bread? Few men are able to rise up to the opportunities of leisure and wealth. To most the freedom of a banking account acts as a narcotic, and begets aimlessness, moral and mental. They skim the surface of life, without plumbing its depths. The honest artisan tastes more of the dignity of life in a day than the idle spendthrift is conscious of in a life-time. As "the better way" for the multitude of men, Catholicism then in the lives of numbers of her saints points to the working-man's life with approval and admonition. She sees in it a moral discipline, good for the greater number, and for some almost necessary to salvation. But she does not impose it as an absolute precept, obligatory upon all. Yet might it be well if at this day there were some such movement in favour of earning one's bread by direct labour, as in the thirteenth century there was a movement in favour of poverty. For even amongst those who have to work, labour is losing its dignity and coming to be regarded as a hateful necessity; and this not merely because of the hateful conditions which have long surrounded the working-man—though these conditions have doubtless had their influence—but because also of a growing spirit of idleness and love of pleasure infecting the whole community. From a moral point of view there is no sign more ominous in our national life. And who does not feel the pitifulness of so many lives amongst those who have no need to work in order to eat—lives latent with useful possibilities, but stunted and warped because of the absence of a moral discipline, such as the necessity to work implies? Well might it be if we had another St Francis, who would teach men to work. And in more cases than not, useful work would mean some sort of manual work—the work of hands and feet as well as of brains.

"Not without reason have the monks raised the virtue which lies in manual labour and external activity. On the one hand it was to them a healthy recreation, obviating the necessity of the harmful excitements in which a wealthy society seeks its distraction."

Not without reason have the monks raised the virtue which lies in manual labour and external activity. On the one hand it was to them a healthy recreation, obviating the necessity of the harmful excitements in which a wealthy society seeks its distraction. On the other hand, it was a useful employment, and as such it had a moral value of its own; for useful employment, however menial, is the atmosphere in which self-respect and manliness flourish—at least, when the employment is of voluntary acceptance, and not taken grudgingly and with protest. In this at least the world may learn a lesson from the monks.

1. Throughout these papers, in speaking of Socialism I quote the views of the extreme school, being well aware that Socialism represents a tendency as well as a programme, and the tendency is best exemplified in the extreme party.

February Saint: St Serenus the Gardener

Upholder of Modesty

Fr Alban Butler

From Lives of the Saints, *Benziger Brothers Edition 1888.*

Serenus was by birth a Grecian. He quitted estate, friends, and country to serve God in celibacy, penance, and prayer. With this design he bought a garden in Sirmium in Pannonia, which he cultivated with his own hands, and lived on the fruits and herbs it produced. One day there came thither a woman, with her two daughters. Serenus, seeing them come up, advised them to withdraw, and to conduct themselves in future as decency required in persons of their sex and condition. The woman, stung at our Saint's charitable remonstrance, retired in confusion, but resolved on revenging the supposed affront. She accordingly wrote to her husband that Serenus had insulted her. He, on receiving her letter, went to the emperor to demand justice, whereupon the emperor gave him a letter to the governor of the province to enable him to obtain satisfaction. The governor ordered Serenus to be immediately brought before him. Serenus, on hearing the charge, answered, "I remember that, some time ago, a lady came into my garden at an unseasonable hour, and I own I took the liberty to tell her it was against decency for one of her sex and quality to be abroad at such an hour." This plea of Serenus having put the officer to the blush for his wife's conduct, he dropped his prosecution. But the governor, suspecting by this answer that Serenus might be a Christian, began to question him, saying, "Who are you, and what is your religion?" Serenus, without hesitating one moment, answered, "I am a Christian. It seemed a while ago as if God rejected me as a stone unfit to enter His building, but He has the goodness to take me now to be placed in it; I am ready to suffer all things for His name, that I may have a part in His kingdom with His Saints." The governor, hearing this burst into rage and said, "Since you sought to elude by flight the emperor's edicts, and have positively refused to sacrifice to the gods, I condemn you for these crimes to lose your head." The sentence was no sooner pronounced than the Saint was carried off and beheaded, on the 23rd of February, in 307.

Reflection The garden affords a beautiful emblem of a Christian's continual progress in the path of virtue. Plants always mount upwards, and never stop in their growth till they have attained to that maturity which the Author of nature has prescribed. So in a Christian, everything ought to carry him toward that perfection which the sanctity of his state requires; and every desire of his soul, every action of his life should be a step advancing to this in a direct line.

The remonstrance in St Serenus' garden. May we all have such a zeal for modesty and comportment as this great saint.